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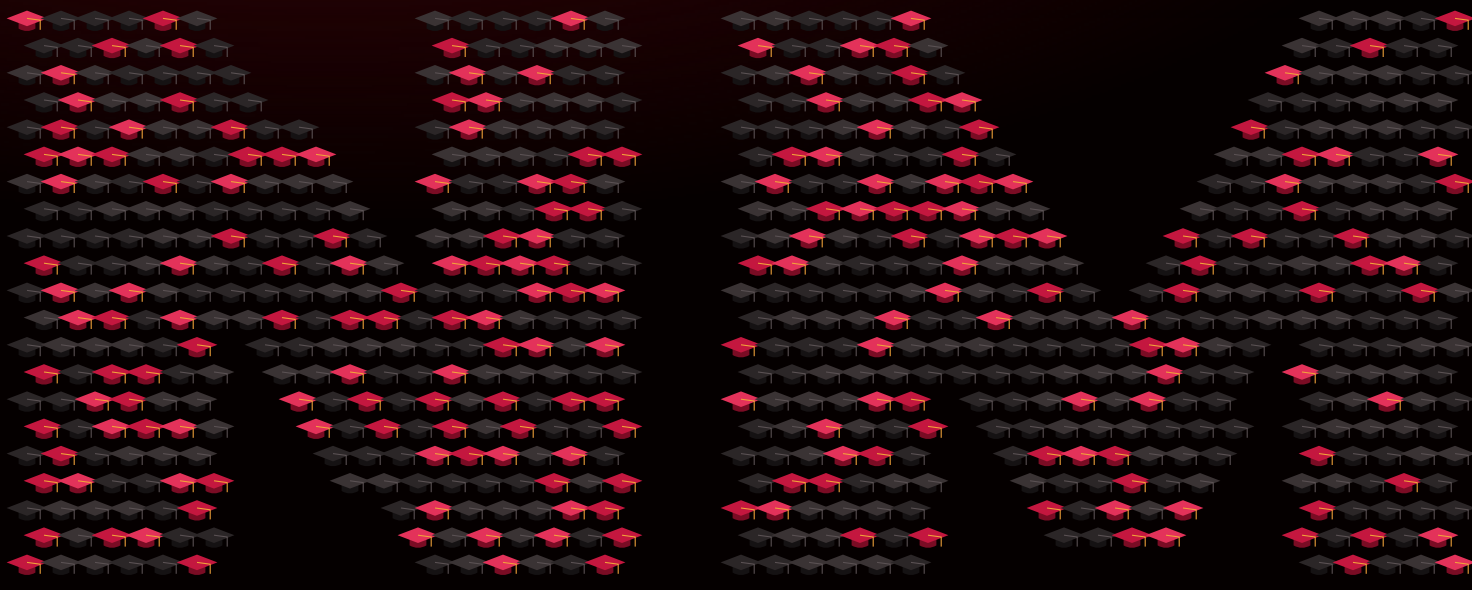
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NOVEMBER 2026

The 2026 New Mexico Talent Profile

Emerson Johnston
Amy Zegart

The bright caps, **31 in every 100**, mark the international share of New Mexico's STEM master's degrees.



The 2026 New Mexico Talent Profile

By Emerson Johnston and Amy Zegart

NOVEMBER 2026

A publication jointly produced by the Hoover Institution and the Institute for Human-Centered Artificial Intelligence at Stanford University.

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Data come from the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), the Department of Homeland Security's SEVIS by the Numbers, the National Assessment of Educational Progress, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates and Survey of Earned Doctorates, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and USPTO patent data via PatentsView, processed in Python; every figure and table is generated from those sources, and each one names its source.

About This Profile

This profile is a companion to *The 2026 US Talent Report: Benchmarking America's STEM Pipeline Amid the Great Talent Competition*. It applies the report's measures to New Mexico: the students the state develops at home, those it draws from abroad, and how both compare with the nation and with the states closest to it in size.

Degrees, enrollment, prices, outcomes and faculty come from IPEDS, the federal census of U.S. colleges and universities, harmonized across 1980–2025. Countries of citizenship come from SEVIS by the Numbers, the Department of Homeland Security's monthly count of active F-1 and M-1 students. Each figure names its source. Peer states are the four closest in total fall enrollment.

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Public Data and Tools

The data behind every chart come from federal sources: the Integrated Postsecondary Education Data System (IPEDS), published by the National Center for Education Statistics, as the backbone, together with NAEP, NSF's surveys of graduate students, doctorates and research funding, USAspending.gov, DHS and ICE SEVIS data, the Department of Labor, USCIS, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, and USPTO PatentsView. Each figure names its source, and the Sources page lists all of them. An interactive version of this profile accompanies the report.

To share any charts and figures, proper attribution is required. This profile is licensed under Attribution-NoDerivatives 4.0 International (CC BY-ND 4.0). Please cite as: The 2026 New Mexico Talent Profile.

AT A GLANCE

What New Mexico's numbers say

1. **International students earn 31% of New Mexico's STEM master's degrees,** 21.4 points below the U.S. (52%) in 2025, ranking 40th of 51 on dependence. The share is 34% for STEM research doctorates (U.S. 43%) and 7.3% for STEM bachelor's (U.S. 6.6%).
2. **New Mexico awarded 237 STEM master's degrees to international students in 2025,** 0.2% of the U.S. total and 40th of 51 among states. Since 2015 the count changed +39%, against 2.2× nationally.
3. **The heaviest dependence is in physical sciences,** where international students earned 39% of master's degrees (83 degrees; U.S. 33%). No STEM field with at least 50 master's graduates are majority-international.
4. **Among states of similar size,** New Mexico ranks 2nd of 5 on the international share of STEM master's: New Mexico 31%, Nevada 30%, District of Columbia 33%, Idaho 18%, West Virginia 10%.
5. **85% of New Mexico's first-time students in fall 2024 were state residents** and 1.8% came from abroad. More residents left for other states (2.99K) than students arrived from them (2.18K), a net loss of 805; the top destination for those leaving was Texas.

31%

of the STEM master's degrees New Mexico awards go to international students (U.S. 52%).

SCORECARD

Nine numbers against the nation

114K #40
Students enrolled, 2024
U.S. **19.7M** · −17% since 2015

237 #40
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · +39% since 2015

31% #40
International share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · +2.7 pp since 2015

10% #34
International share of grad students, 2024
U.S. **17%** · −1.5 pp since 2015

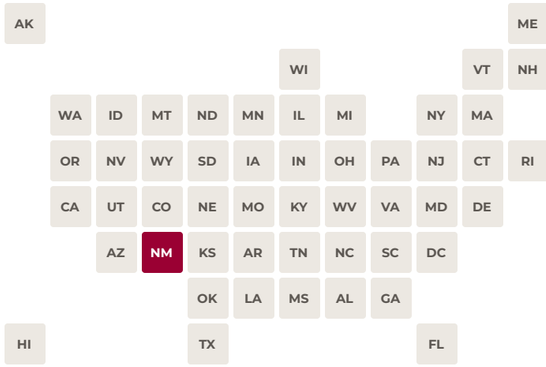
22% #30
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · +2.3 pp since 2015

50% #50
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · +10.5 pp since 2015

$23K #3
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · +69% since 2015

85% #7
First-time students from in state, 2024
U.S. **–** · +0.6 pp since 2016

$84.6K #39
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · −3.0% since 2016



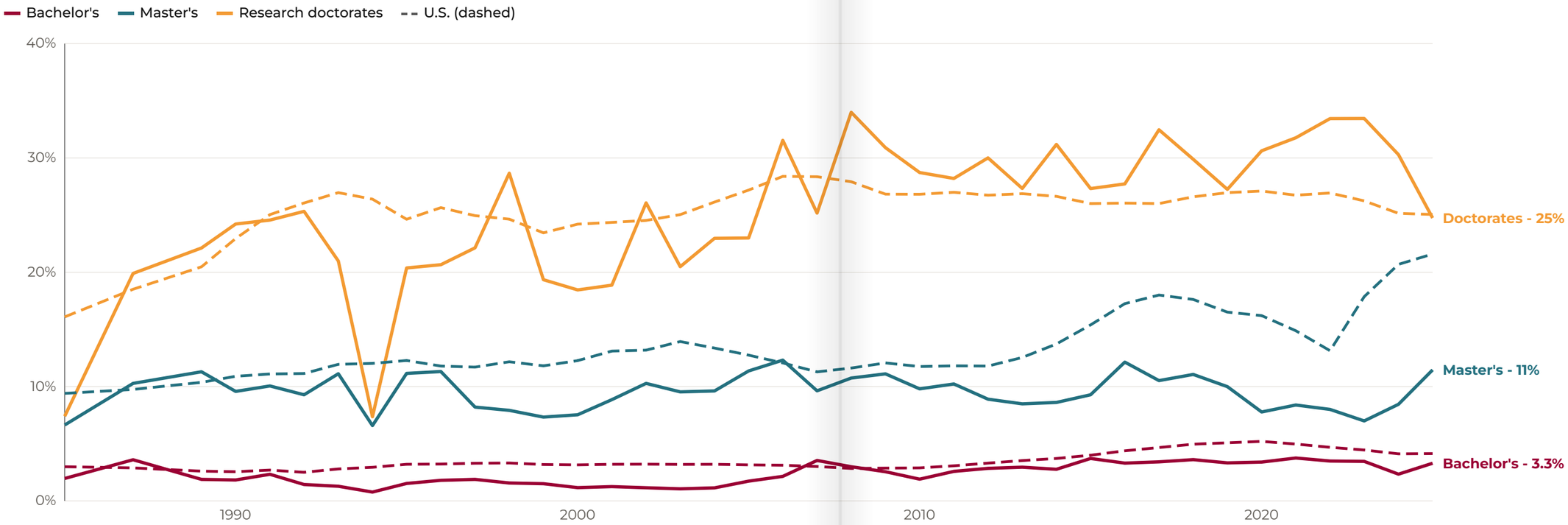
Badges give New Mexico's rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Changes are since 2015.

SECTION 1

International Dependence

New Mexico ranks 40th of 51 on the international share of STEM master's, at 31% in 2025 against 52% for the U.S.

Figure 1 What Share of New Mexico's Degrees Go to International Students?



International share of degrees awarded, all fields; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions, 1985–2025.

International students make up 10% of New Mexico's graduate enrollment and 1.7% of its undergraduates. Dependence climbs with each degree: 3.3% of bachelor's, 11% of master's and 25% of research doctorates go to international students.

In STEM the shares are higher still: 7.3% of STEM bachelor's, 31% of STEM master's and 34% of STEM doctorates. The state awards 0.2% of all U.S. international STEM master's, 40th of 51.

10%

Int. share of grad students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **34th** of 51 · −1.5 pp since 2015

11%

Int. share of all master's, 2025

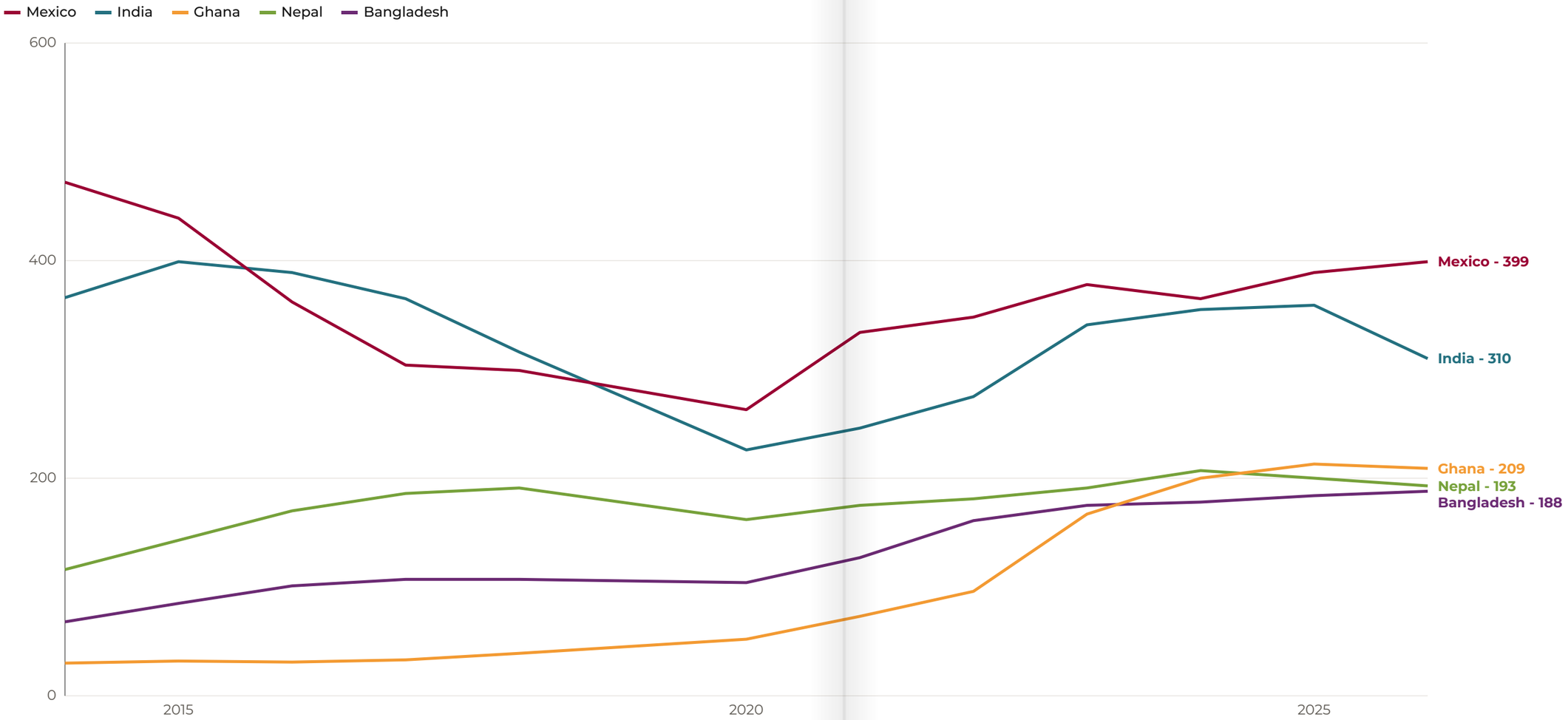
U.S. **22%** · **35th** of 51 · +2.2 pp since 2015

31%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **52%** · **40th** of 51 · +2.7 pp since 2015

Figure 2 Where Do New Mexico's International Students Come From?



Active F-1 and M-1 students by country of citizenship, the five largest in October 2026; one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November), October 2014–October 2026. All education levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

In October 2026, New Mexico had 3.34K active international students in SEVIS, 42nd of 51. Mexico accounted for 12% of them and India for 9.3%, against 1.5% and 27% nationally.

Students came from 141 countries, but the two largest supplied 21%. The state's total is down 6% since 2015, when it stood at 3.57K.

3.34K
Active international students, October 2026
42nd of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

12%
From Mexico
U.S. **1.5%**

58%
In STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

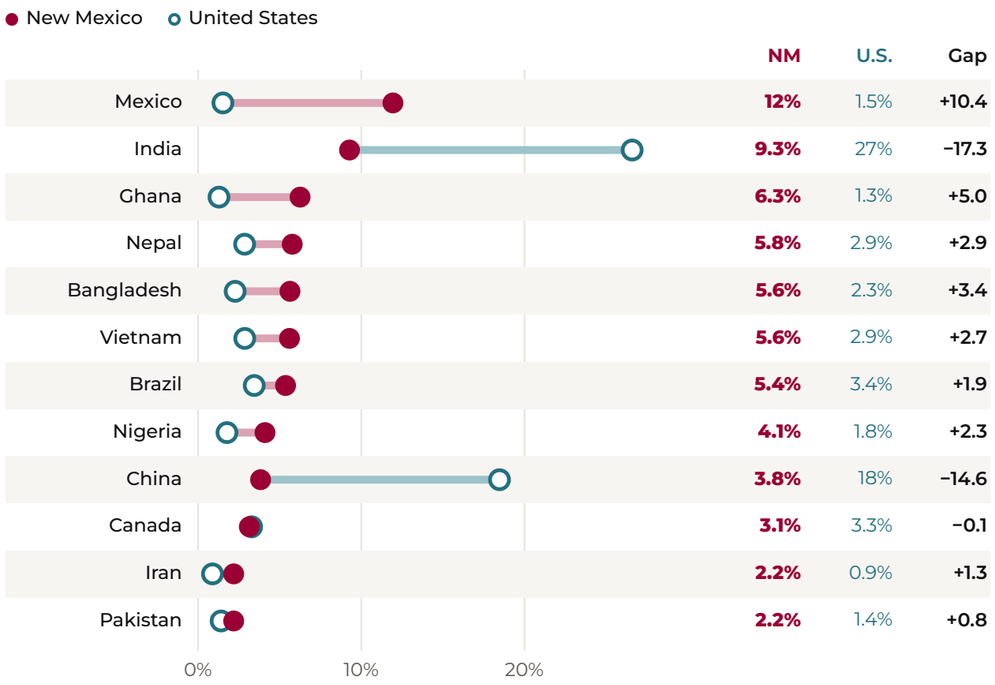
How Does New Mexico's Mix of Countries Compare With the Nation's?

In October 2026, New Mexico had **3.34K** active F-1 and M-1 students, 42nd among the 50 states and DC and **0.3%** of the U.S. total. They came from 141 countries.

Mexico supplied **12%** of them, against 1.5% nationally, and India **9.3%**, against 27%. Ghana (6.3%), Nepal (5.8%), and Bangladesh (5.6%) followed.

Together the two largest countries supplied **21%** of the state's international students (U.S. 45%), 46th among the states, against 27% in 2015.

Figure 3 Is New Mexico's Mix of Countries Like the Nation's?



Share of active F-1 and M-1 students, all levels. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

3.34K
Active international students, October 2026
42nd of 51 · U.S. **1.19M**

12%
From Mexico
U.S. **1.5%**

9.3%
From India
U.S. **27%**

141
Countries represented
U.S. **219**

The state's count is up 0.2% from 2025 and down 6.5% since 2015, when it stood at 3.57K. Its share of all U.S. international students is unchanged since 2015, at **0.3%**.

Since 2015, the number of students from Mexico went from 439 to 399, India's from 399 to 310, and Ghana's from 32 to 209.

Over the same years, the number from Nepal went from 143 to 193 and Bangladesh's from 85 to 188. The table gives each country's count for the first, previous and latest years.

Table 1 International Students in New Mexico, 2015–2026

	2015	2025	2026	Change since 2015	U.S. 2026	Rank
ALL INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS						
Active F-1 and M-1 students	3.57K	3.33K	**3.34K**	−6.5%	1.19M	42nd
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.3%	0.3%	**0.3%**	0.0 pp	–	42nd
Countries of citizenship represented	141	140	**141**	+0.0%	219	39th
Share from the two largest countries of origin	27%	22%	**21%**	−6.2 pp	45%	46th
LARGEST COUNTRIES OF CITIZENSHIP (STUDENTS)					**U.S. SHARE**	**STATE SHARE**
Mexico	439	389	**399**	−9.1%	1.5%	12%
India	399	359	**310**	−22%	27%	9.3%
Ghana	32	213	**209**	–	1.3%	6.3%
Nepal	143	200	**193**	+35%	2.9%	5.8%
Bangladesh	85	184	**188**	+121%	2.3%	5.6%

Active F-1 and M-1 students, one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November; 2019 has none; the latest year is October 2026). Rank among the 50 states and DC. Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers.

Figure 4

Which Countries Supply New Mexico's International STEM Students?

1.92K of New Mexico's international students were in STEM fields in October 2026, **58%** of the total against 63% nationally, up 9.2% since 2015.

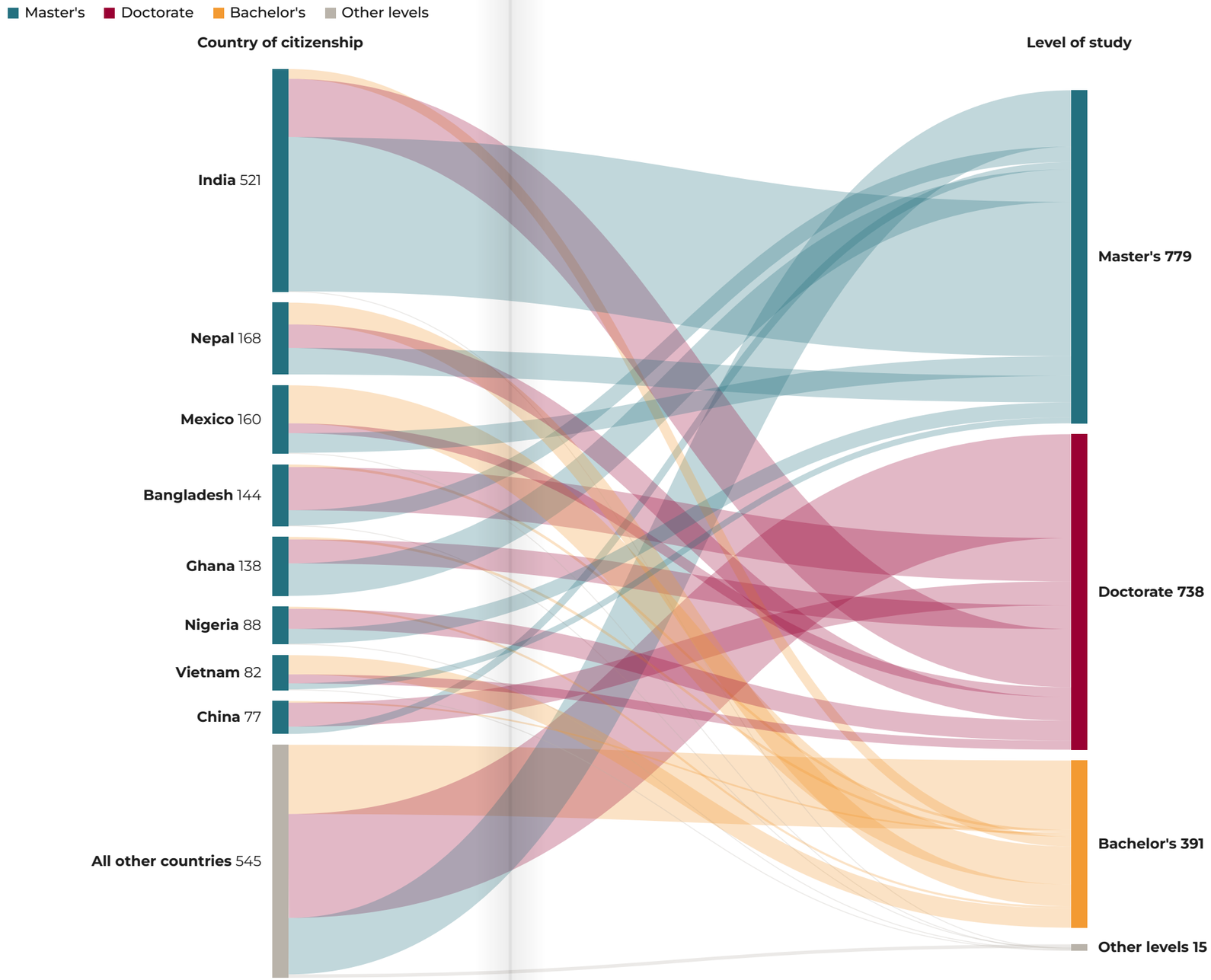
Master's students were the largest group, **779**. India supplied 46% of them and Ghana 9.8%.

STEM doctoral students went from 624 in 2015 to **738**, and STEM master's students from 592 to 779.

1.92K
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students, 2026
U.S. **749K** · **42nd** of 51 · +9.2% since 2015

58%
Share in STEM fields
U.S. **63%**

779
Active STEM master's students, 2026
U.S. **393K** · **40th** of 51 · +32% since 2015



Active F-1 and M-1 students in STEM fields by country of citizenship and level of study, October 2026; the eight largest countries are shown. DHS does not draw its STEM pages on the same basis as its all-student pages, so the STEM count here exceeds the all-level count for India (521 against 310). Data from DHS, SEVIS by the Numbers, October 2026.

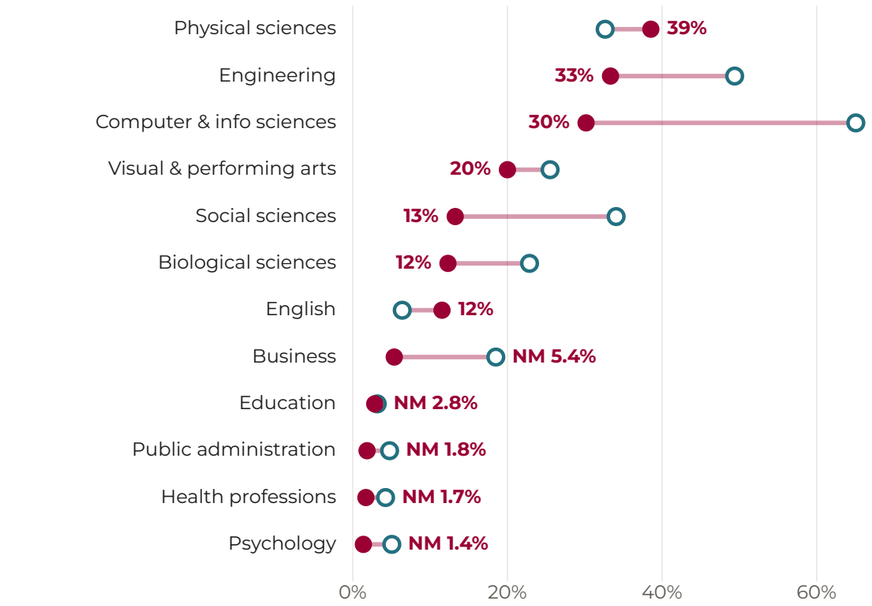
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How International Are New Mexico's Master's Fields?

Each row is a master's field with at least 30 graduates in New Mexico in 2025, ranked by the share of degrees earned by international students (U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas). The filled dot is the state's share; the open dot is the national share for the same field.

Highest international shares. International students earned the largest shares of master's degrees in physical sciences (39%, against 33% for the U.S.), engineering (33%, against 49% for the U.S.), and computer & info sciences (30%, against 65% for the U.S.).

Figure 5 Which Master's Fields Depend Most on International Students?



International share of master's degrees by field, 2025; fields with 30+ graduates. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

11%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **35th** of 51

31%
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **40th** of 51

30%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **41st** of 47

The table gives the international share of degrees in each STEM field at three levels: New Mexico first, the United States after the slash. The master's column is highlighted. A dash means the state awarded no degrees in the field at that level.

Highest international share among STEM master's fields. International students earned 39% of the master's degrees in physical sciences, against 33% for the U.S.

Table 2 How International Is Each STEM Field?

Field	Bachelor's	Master's	Doctorates
Computer & info sciences	7.1% / 8.6%	**30% / 65%**	– / 56%
Engineering	13% / 7.2%	**33% / 49%**	35% / 55%
Engineering technology	1.8% / 4.5%	**– / 54%**	– / 42%
Math & statistics	2.1% / 17%	**62% / 55%**	– / 53%
Physical sciences	2.9% / 6.0%	**39% / 33%**	18% / 38%
Biological sciences	2.8% / 3.4%	**12% / 23%**	– / 23%
Natural resources	0.0% / 2.0%	**– / 17%**	– / 27%
Architecture	6.0% / 7.3%	**7.7% / 29%**	– / 55%

International share in New Mexico / U.S., 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

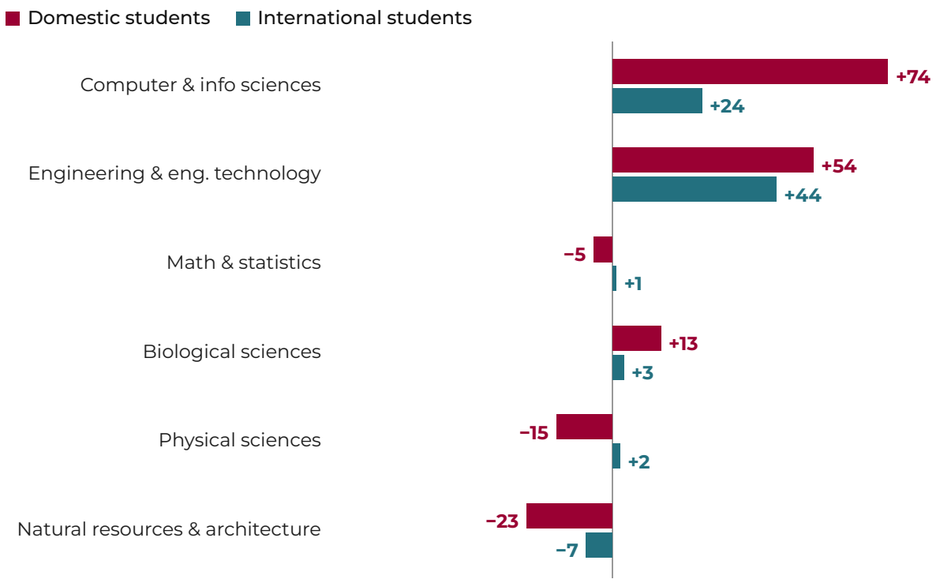
SECTION 1 · INTERNATIONAL DEPENDENCE

How Has New Mexico's STEM Master's Output Grown?

Each pair of bars is the change in the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in New Mexico between 2015 and 2025 in one field: to domestic students (U.S. citizens and permanent residents) and to international students. Bars to the left of the axis are declines.

STEM master's degrees. The state awarded 771 in 2025 and 606 in 2015, a change of +67 for international students and +98 for domestic students.

Figure 6 Where Did the STEM Master's Growth Come From?



Change in STEM master's degrees by field, 2015–2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

237
International STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **117K** · **40th** of 51

24%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **18th** of 51

0.2%
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025
40th of 51

4.8
STEM master's per STEM research doctorate, 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **32nd** of 51

The table gives the number of STEM master's degrees awarded in New Mexico in each field in 2015 and 2025, the change between the two years, the number awarded to international students in 2025, and international students' share of the field's degrees in each year.

STEM share of master's degrees. The share was 24% in 2025, against 23% for the U.S., 18th among the states, up 2.6 points from 21% in 2024 and up 5.8 points since 2015, when it was 18%.

Table 3 How Many STEM Master's Degrees Does Each Field Award?

Field	2015	2025	Change	International 2025	Int. share 2015	Int. share 2025
Computer & info sciences	81	**179**	+121%	54	37%	30%
Engineering & eng. technology	271	**369**	+36%	122	29%	33%
Math & statistics	33	**29**	–	18	52%	–
Biological sciences	49	**65**	–	8	10%	12%
Physical sciences	96	**83**	−14%	32	31%	39%
Natural resources & architecture	76	**46**	−39%	3	13%	6.5%

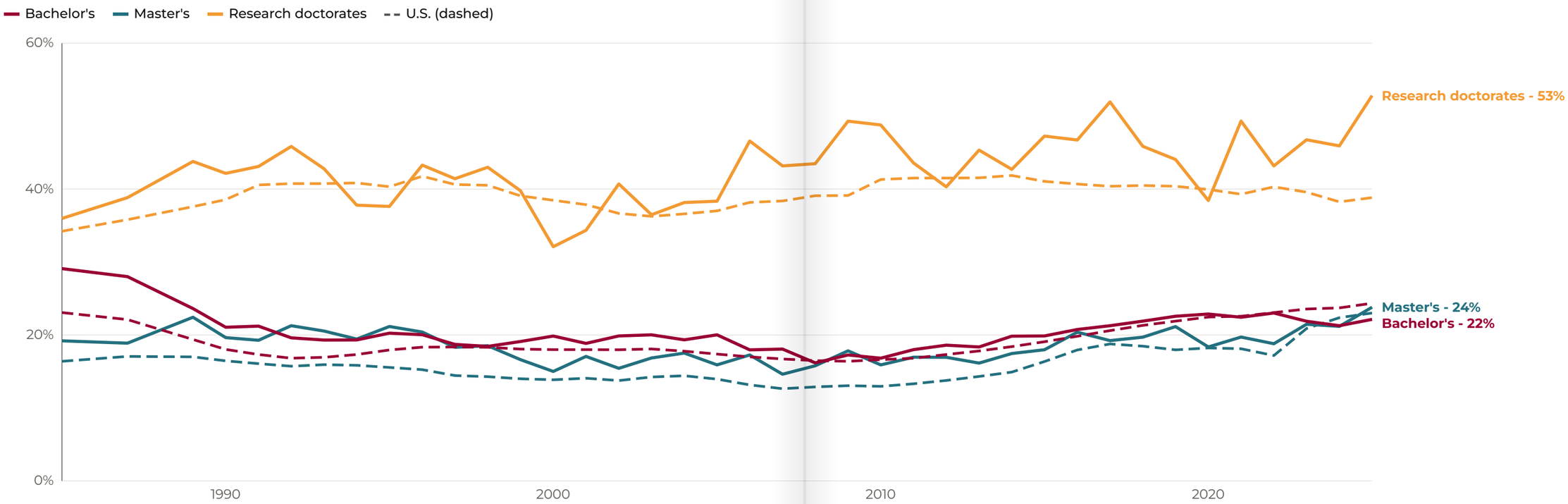
STEM master's degrees awarded in New Mexico, all students and international students, 2015 and 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

SECTION 2

STEM Degrees

New Mexico ranks 8th of 51 on the STEM share of research doctorates, at 53% in 2025 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 7 How Much of New Mexico's Degree Output Is STEM?



STEM share of degrees by level; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

STEM fields account for 22% of New Mexico's bachelor's degrees, 24% of its master's and 53% of its research doctorates (U.S. 24%, 23% and 39%).

The STEM share of master's degrees is up 5.8 points since 2015, and the state ranks 18th of 51 on it. On the STEM share of bachelor's degrees it ranks 30th of 51.

22%

STEM share of bachelor's, 2025

U.S. **24%** · **30th** of 51 · +2.3 pp since 2015

24%

STEM share of master's, 2025

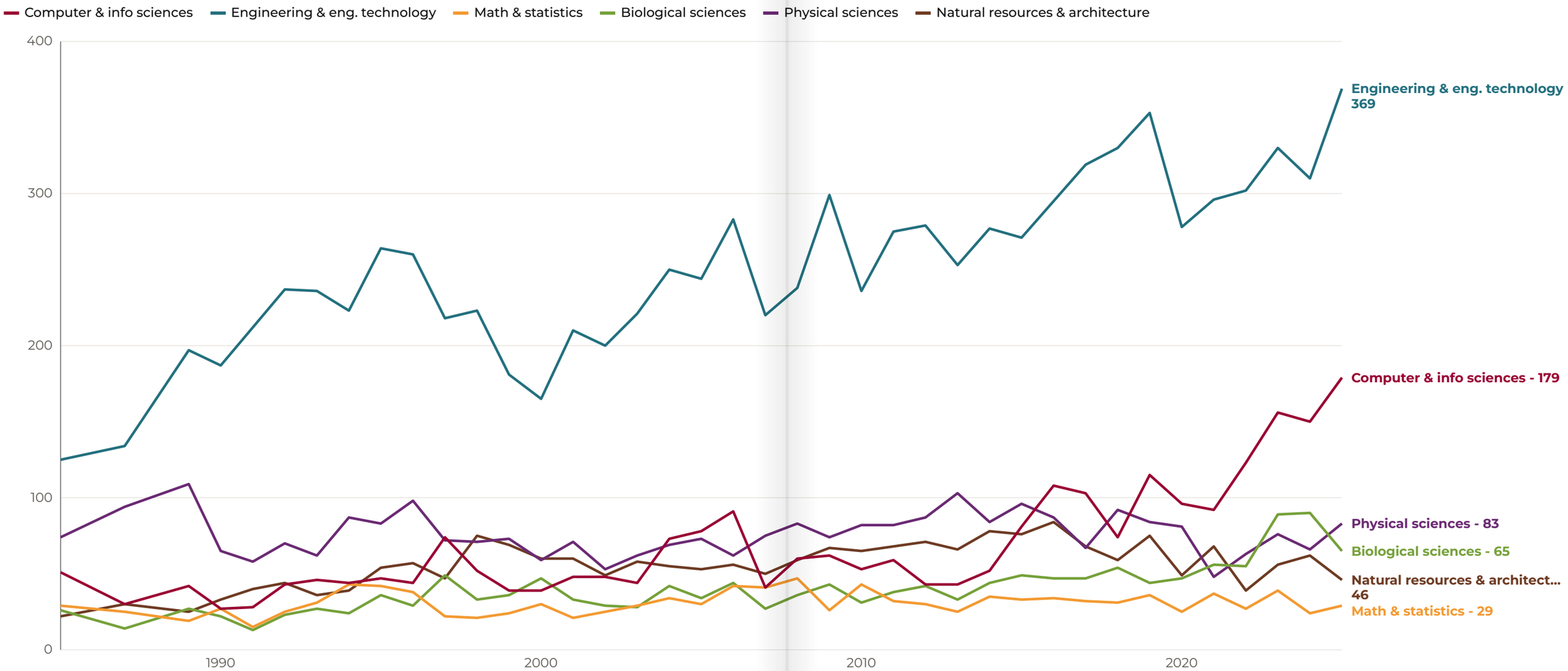
U.S. **23%** · **18th** of 51 · +5.8 pp since 2015

53%

STEM share of research doctorates, 2025

U.S. **39%** · **8th** of 51 · +5.5 pp since 2015

Figure 8 Which STEM Fields Produce New Mexico's Master's Degrees?



STEM master's degrees by field, all students. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Engineering & eng. technology produced the most STEM master's degrees in 2025, 369, followed by computer & info sciences (179) and physical sciences (83). Master's degrees in engineering & eng. technology are up 36% since 2015.

International students earned 237 of the state's STEM master's degrees in 2025, 0.2% of the national total (40th of 51).

237

International STEM master's, 2025

U.S. **117K** · **40th** of 51 · +39% since 2015

0.2%

Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025

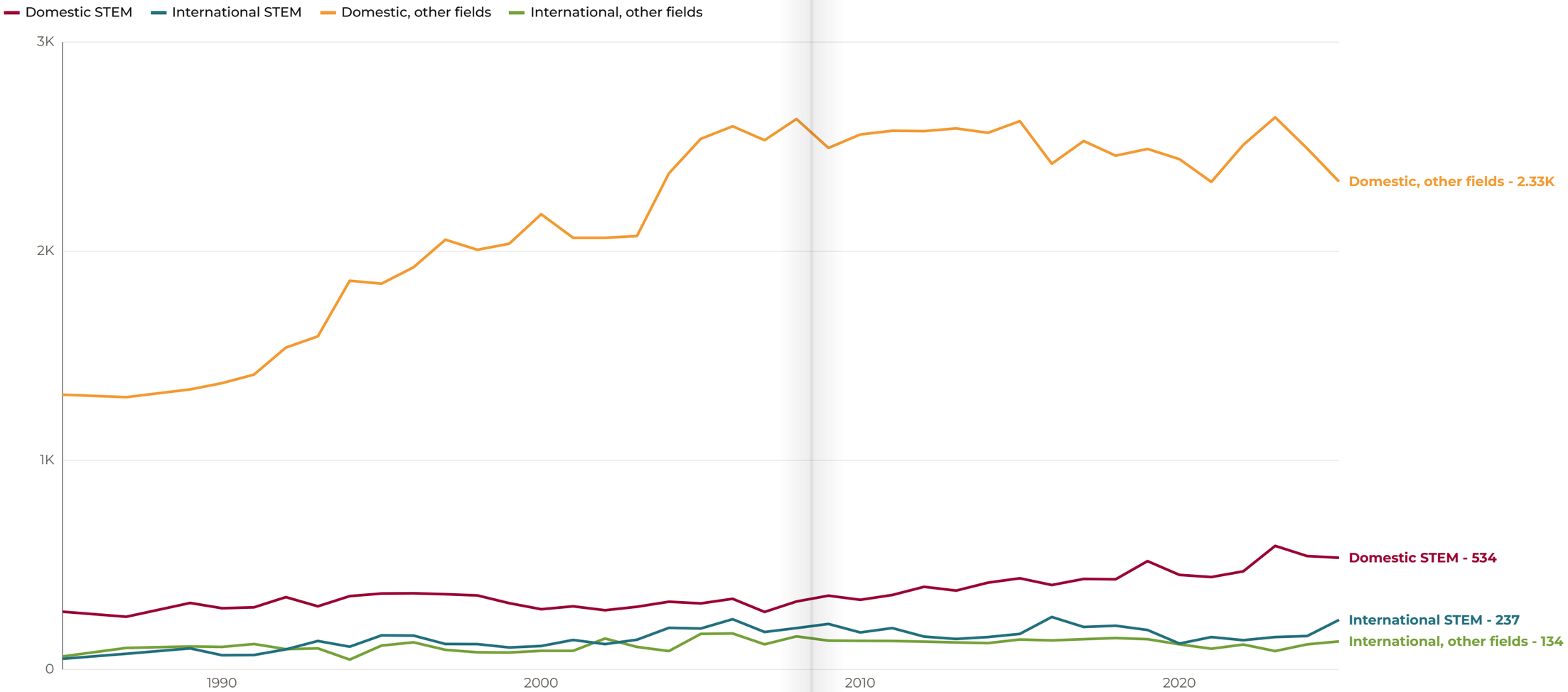
· **40th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2015

30%

Int. share of CS master's, 2025

U.S. **65%** · **41st** of 47 · −6.9 pp since 2015

Figure 9 Who Earns New Mexico's Master's Degrees?



Master's degrees by student residency and field group. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Between 2015 and 2025, 67 more STEM master's degrees went to international students and 98 more to domestic students.

International students earn 31% of New Mexico's STEM master's but 5.4% of master's in other fields (U.S. 52% and 12%).

11%

Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **35th** of 51 · +2.2 pp since 2015

31%

Int. share of STEM master's, 2025
U.S. **52%** · **40th** of 51 · +2.7 pp since 2015

4.8

STEM master's per STEM research doctorate (IPEDS), 2025
U.S. **6.4** · **32nd** of 51 · +1.3 since 2015

SECTION 3

Where Students Come From

New Mexico ranks 7th of 51 on the share of first-time students who are in-state residents, at 85% in 2024.

Figure 10 First-Time Students by Home and Destination, Fall 2024



Home of first-time degree-seeking undergraduates (left) and the state of the institution entered (right); the five largest sources and destinations, the rest grouped. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

14.6K residents stayed in New Mexico for college in fall 2024; 2.18K students arrived from other states and 303 from abroad, while 2.99K residents left.

Each band runs from a student's home on the left to the state where they enrolled on the right. 85% of the state's first-time students are residents (U.S. –).

85%

First-time students from in state, 2024

· **7th** of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2016

1.8%

First-time students from abroad, 2024

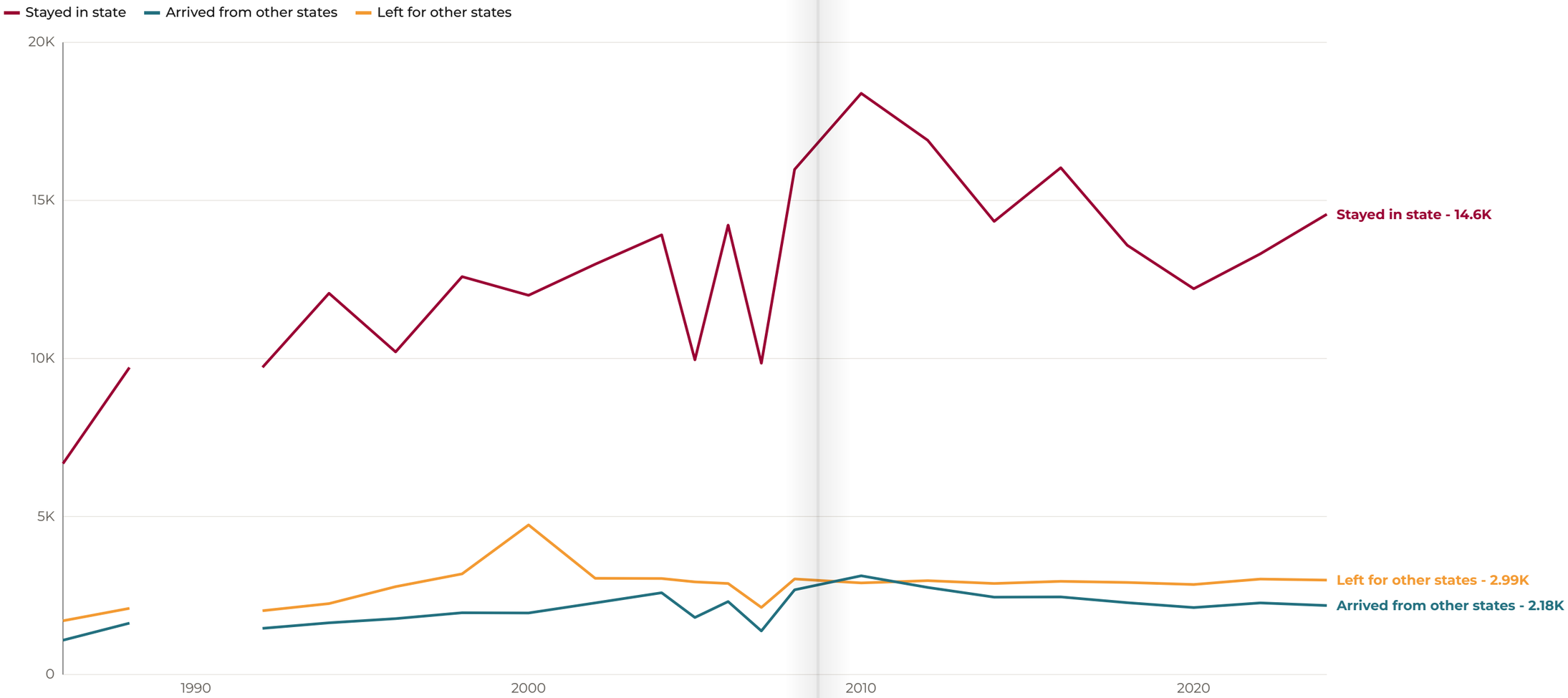
U.S. **3.1%** · **38th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2016

−5

Net migration per 100 residents, 2024

· **39th** of 51 · −2.0 since 2016

Figure 11 How Have the Flows Changed?



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by flow; even years before 2001. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Since 2015, the number of residents staying in state for college is down 9%, arrivals from other states are down 11%, and residents leaving are roughly flat.

Net migration was −5 per 100 resident first-time students (39th of 51). The top destination for residents who left was Texas (560).

Figure 12

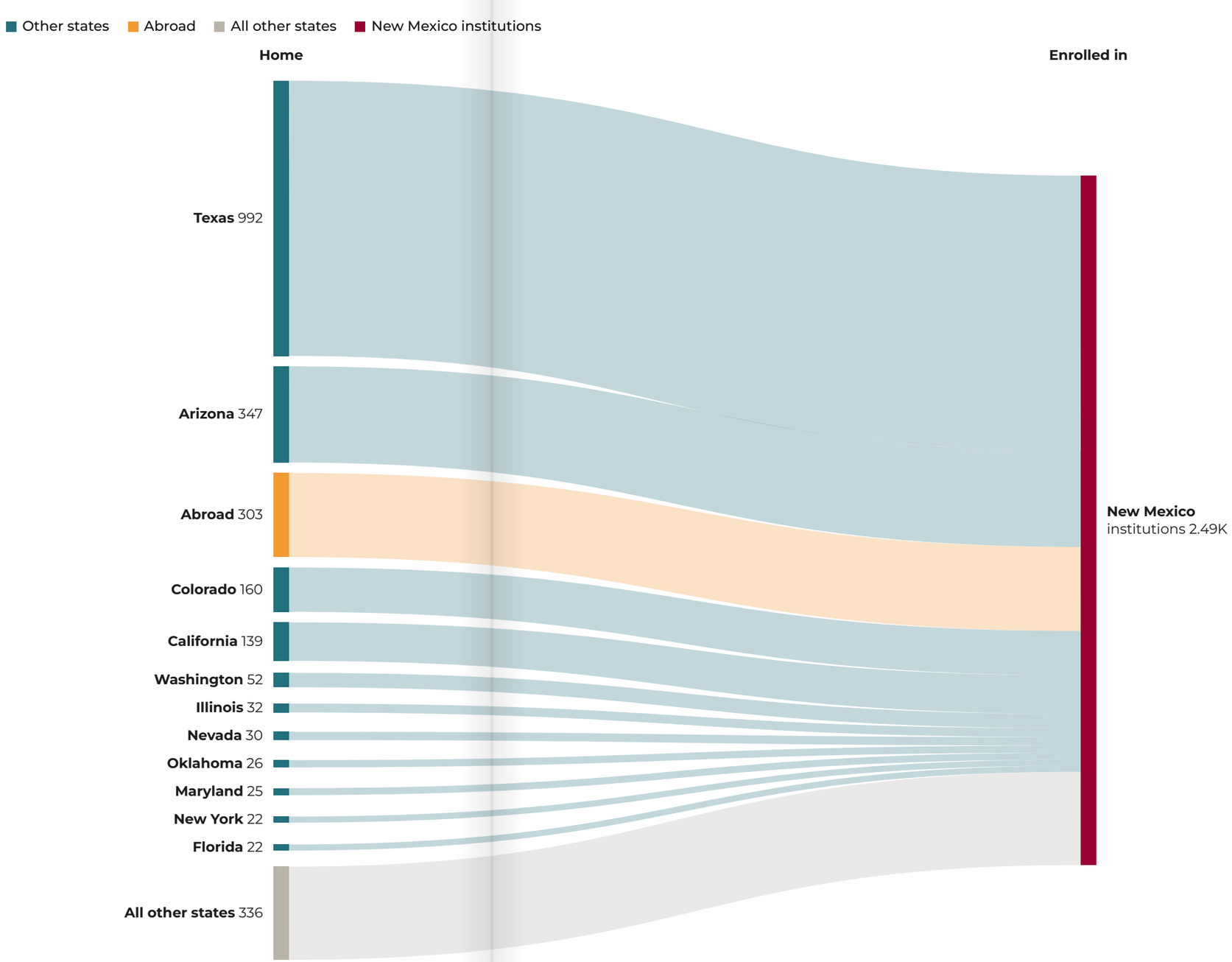
Where Do New Mexico's Newcomers Come From?

The bands show where first-time degree-seeking undergraduates who enrolled at New Mexico's institutions in fall 2024 but did not live in the state came from: the 12 largest home states and students from abroad, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Home is the state where the student lived when admitted.

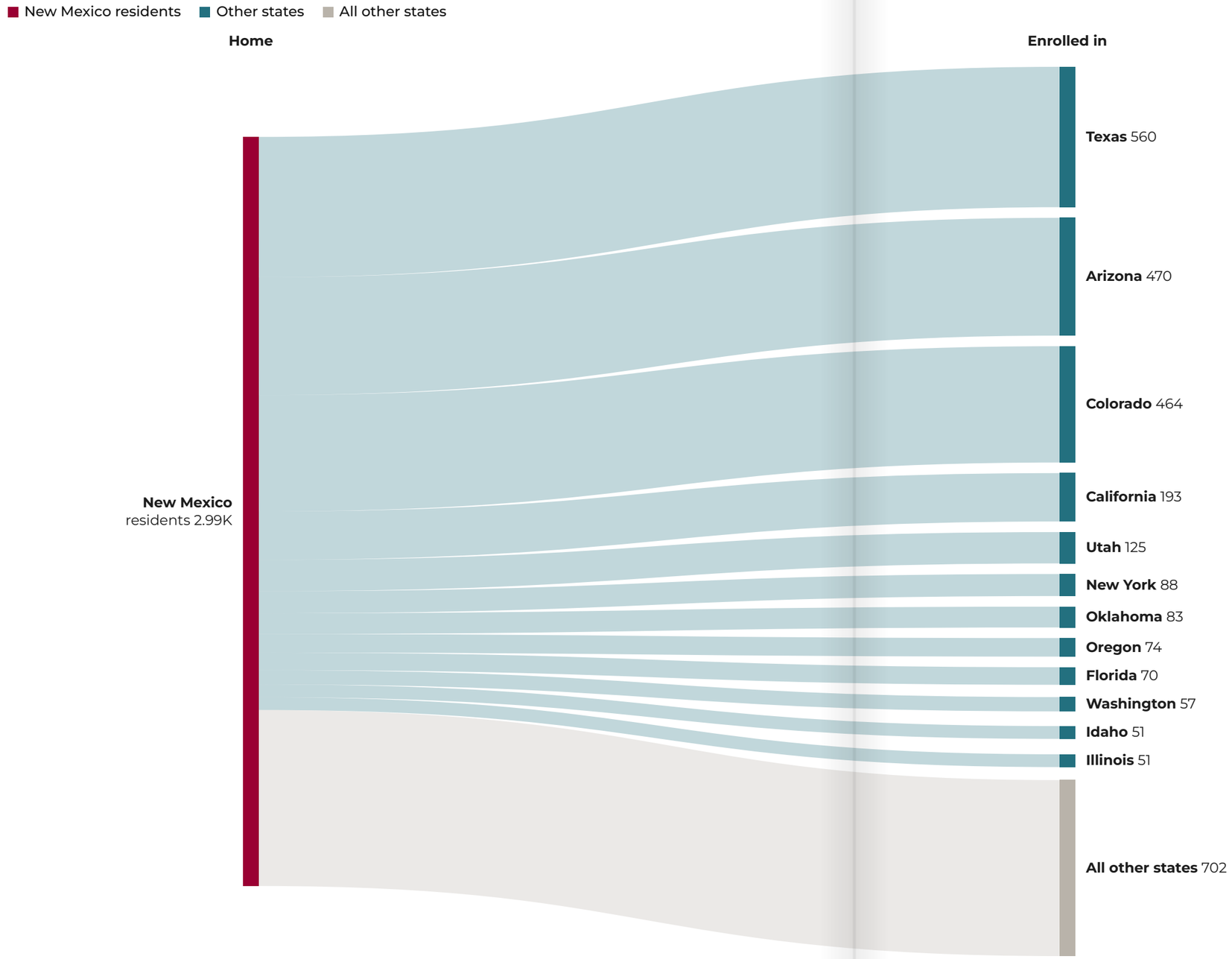
2.49K
First-time students from other states and abroad, fall 2024
Abroad **303**

1.8%
First-time students from abroad, 2024
U.S. **3.1%** · **38th** of 51 · −0.1 pp since 2016

85%
First-time students from in state, 2024
7th of 51 · +0.6 pp since 2016



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.



First-time degree-seeking undergraduates, fall 2024; the 12 largest flows. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

Figure 13

Where Do New Mexico's Residents Go When They Leave?

The bands show where New Mexico residents who left the state to start college in fall 2024 enrolled: the 12 largest destination states, with all other states grouped. Band widths are proportional to the number of students. Residents who enrolled in the state are not shown.

Residents leaving for other states. The number was 2.99K in fall 2024, down 1.1% from 3.02K in fall 2022 and up 1.3% since fall 2016, when it was 2.95K.

2.99K
Residents who started college in another state, fall 2024
Arrived from other states **2.18K** · **2.49K** with abroad

−5
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024
39th of 51 · −2.0 since 2016

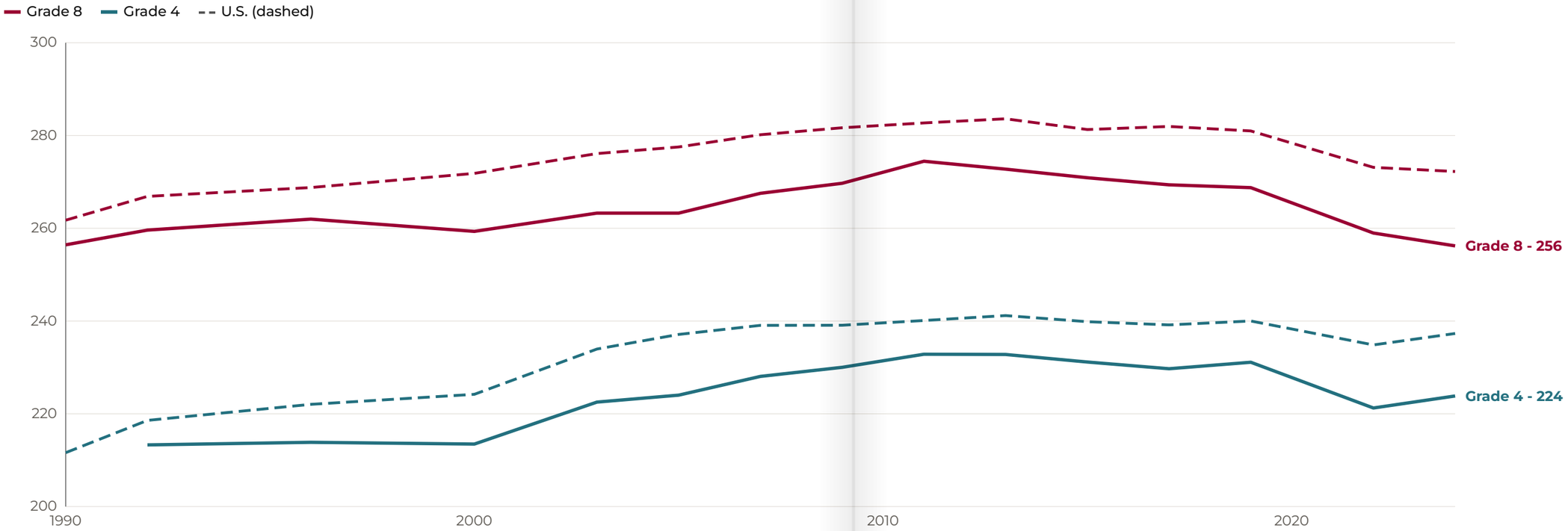
560
Went to Texas
The largest destination

SECTION 4

K-12 Preparation

New Mexico ranks 51st of 51 on the average grade 8 mathematics score, at 256 in 2024 against 272 for the U.S.

Figure 14 How Well Prepared in Mathematics Are New Mexico's Students?



Average NAEP mathematics score, public schools, 0–500 scale; state solid, U.S. public schools dashed. Data from NCES, National Assessment of Educational Progress.

The talent pipeline starts in school. New Mexico's eighth graders averaged 256 in mathematics on the 2024 NAEP, against 272 for U.S. public schools, 51st of 51 among the states.

14% scored at or above the Proficient level (U.S. 27%). Differences of a point or two are often within the margin of error.

256

Grade 8 math score (NAEP), 2024

U.S. **272** · **51st** of 51 · −14.7 since 2015

14%

Grade 8 math, at or above Proficient, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **51st** of 51 · −6.6 pp since 2015

245

Grade 8 reading score (NAEP), 2024

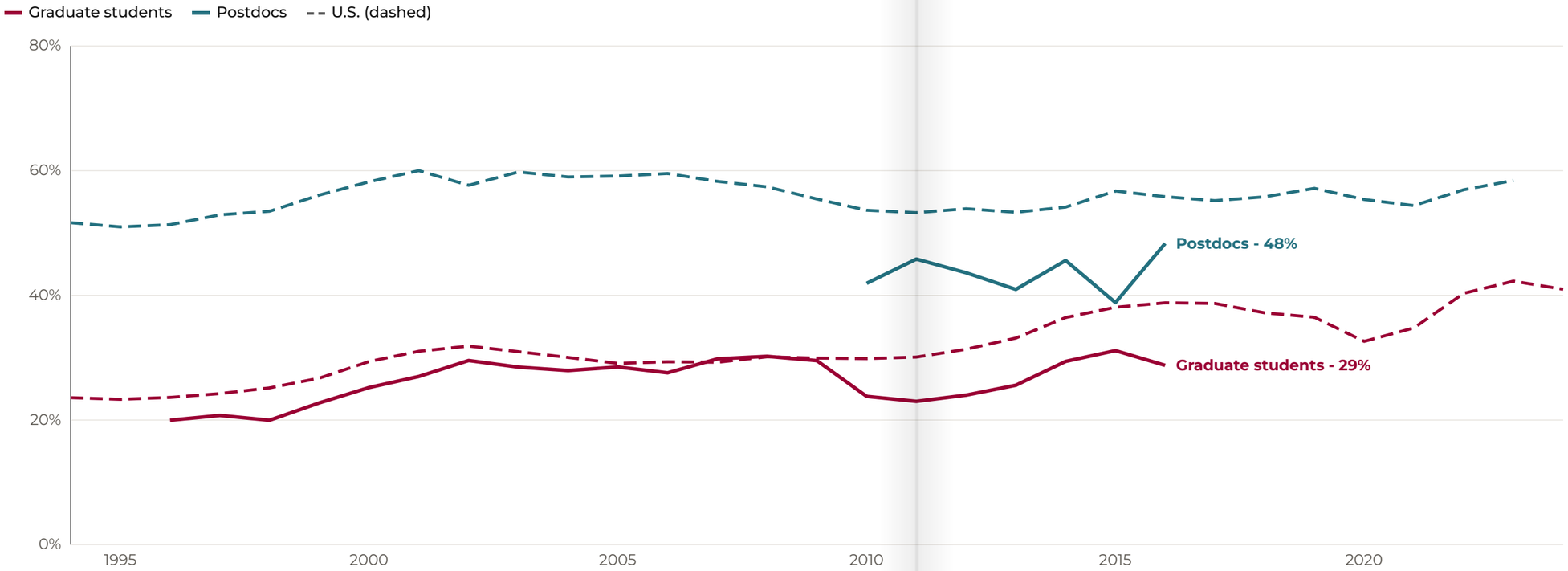
U.S. **257** · **51st** of 51 · −8.2 since 2015

SECTION 5

Graduate Research

New Mexico ranks 39th of 51 on research doctorates awarded, at 272 in 2025 against 59K for the U.S.

Figure 15 How Many of New Mexico's Science and Engineering Graduate Students Hold Temporary Visas?



Temporary-visa share of science and engineering graduate students and postdoctoral appointees, by the institution's state; state solid, U.S. dashed. NSF stopped publishing state tables after 2016. Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates.

In 2016, the last year NSF published state tables, 29% of New Mexico's science and engineering graduate students held temporary visas (U.S. 39%; 36th of 51).

Among postdoctoral researchers, the share was 48% (U.S. 56%). Postdocs are the stage of research training most dependent on international talent, and IPEDS does not count them.

The state's institutions awarded 272 research doctorates in 2025, 0.5% of the U.S. total (Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Earned Doctorates; NSF publishes doctorates by citizenship only for the nation).

29%
S&E grad students on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **39%** · **36th** of 51 · −2.3 pp since 2015

48%
S&E postdocs on temporary visas, 2016
U.S. **56%** · **36th** of 51 · +9.5 pp since 2015

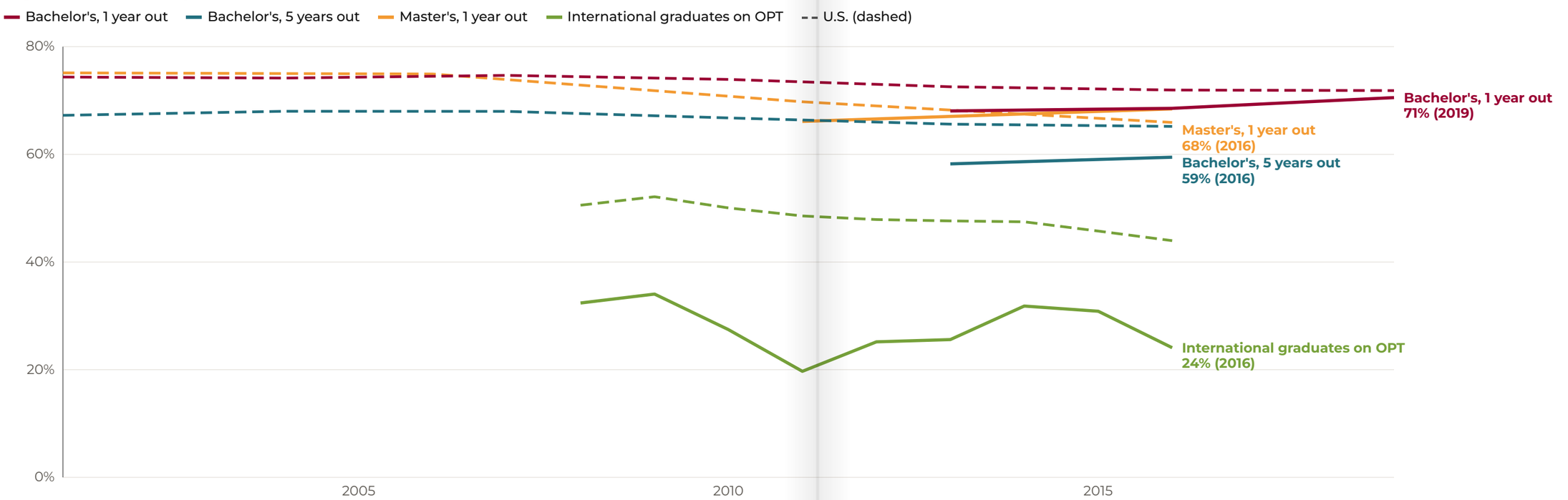
272
Research doctorates awarded (NSF SED), 2025
U.S. **59K** · **39th** of 51 · −21% since 2015

SECTION 6

Do Graduates Stay?

New Mexico ranks 44th of 51 on net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents, at −5.9 in 2025.

Figure 16 How Many of New Mexico's Graduates Go On to Work in the State?



Share of employed graduates working in the state of their institution, by graduating cohort (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes; participating institutions only); international graduates' OPT jobs in the state where they studied (Data from ICE, SEVIS FOIA releases; shares only, the file is truncated). State solid, U.S. or participating states dashed.

Of New Mexico's bachelor's graduates who were working a year after graduating, 71% worked in the state (participating states 72%). Five years out the share was 59%.

Among international graduates on Optional Practical Training in 2016, 24% worked in the state where they studied (U.S. 44%). That is the last year the released records cover, before most of the growth in international STEM master's degrees since 2015. Through migration between states, the state lost 5.9 bachelor's-plus adults per 1,000 such residents in 2025 (Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey).

71%

Bachelor's grads working in-state, 1 year out, 2019

U.S. **72%** · **14th** of 33 · +2.0 pp since 2016

24%

OPT graduates working in the state, 2016

U.S. **44%** · **42nd** of 51 · −6.8 pp since 2015

−5.9

Net migration, bachelor's-plus, per 1,000, 2025

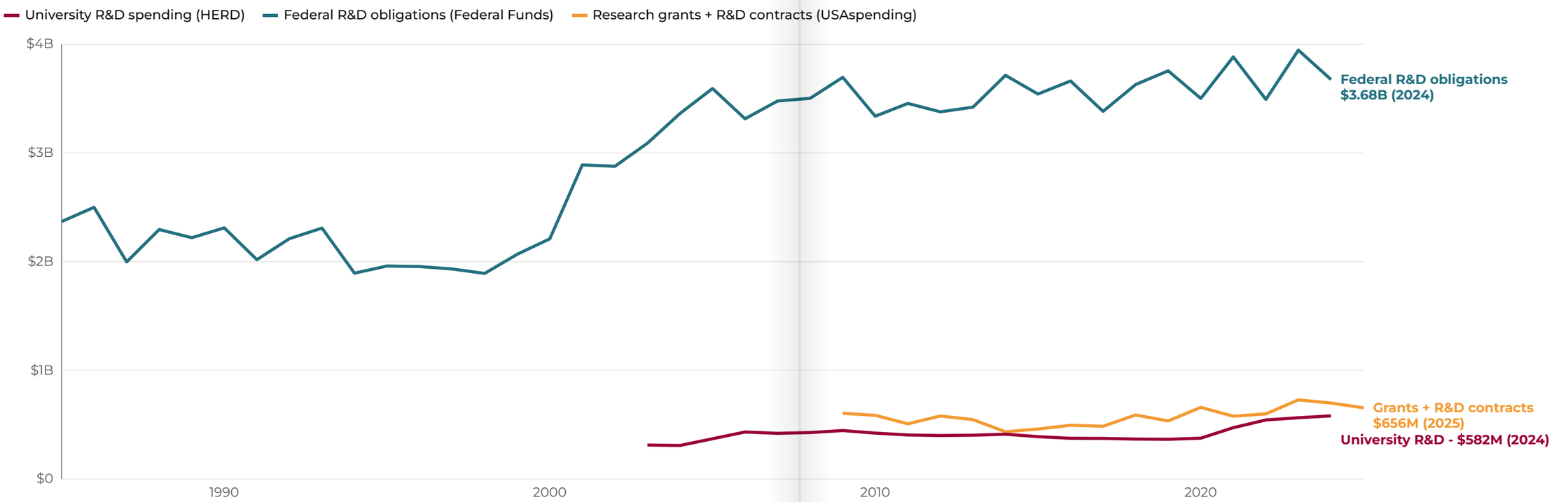
· **44th** of 51 · +3.7 since 2015

SECTION 7

Research Funding

New Mexico ranks 8th of 51 on the federally funded share of university R&D, at 63% in 2024 against 55% for the U.S.

Figure 17 How Much Research Money Flows Into New Mexico?



Nominal dollars (not adjusted for inflation), fiscal years; a line ending before the others is labeled with its last year. University R&D: Data from NSF NCSES, Higher Education Research and Development Survey (FY2003-09 predecessor survey). Federal R&D obligations by state of performance: Data from NSF NCSES, Survey of Federal Funds for R&D (coverage widens in FY2021). Grants from NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science plus R&D contracts: Data from USAspending.gov.

New Mexico's universities spent $582M on research and development in FY2024, 37th of 51 among the states; 63% of it was federally funded (U.S. 55%).

Federal agencies obligated $3.68B for R&D performed in the state in FY2024. Research funding drives demand for graduate students and postdocs, the stage of training most dependent on international talent.

$582M

University R&D spending, 2024

U.S. **$118B** · **37th** of 51 · +49% since 2015

63%

Federal share of university R&D, 2024

U.S. **55%** · **8th** of 51 · −1.7 pp since 2015

$3.68B

Federal R&D obligations, 2024

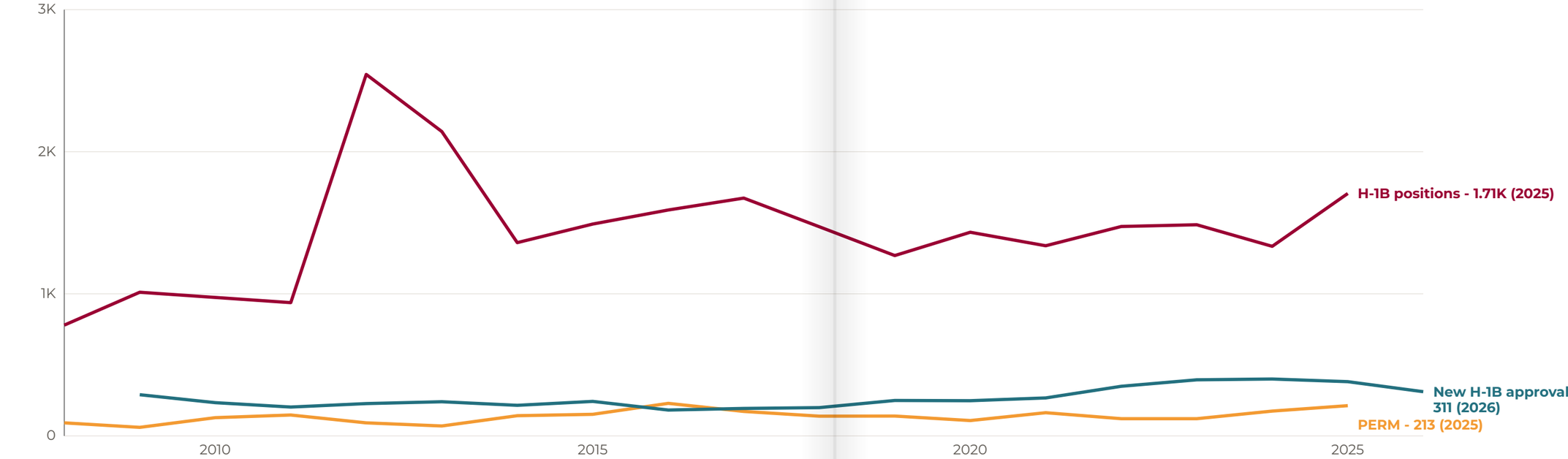
U.S. **$193B** · **16th** of 51 · +3.7% since 2015

SECTION 8

H-1B Jobs and Green Cards

New Mexico ranks 4th of 51 on the share of PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas, at 20% in 2024 against 8.7% for the U.S.

Figure 18 How Many Skilled-Visa Jobs and Green-Card Certifications Does New Mexico Generate?



Certified H-1B positions on labor condition applications by worksite and certified PERM green-card applications, by fiscal year (Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification); new H-1B petition approvals by the employer's address (Data from USCIS, H-1B Employer Data Hub).

Employers were certified for 1.71K H-1B positions at New Mexico worksites in FY2025, 39th of 51 among the states. A labor condition application comes before the petition and covers renewals and job changes as well as new hires, by the worksite's state, so it runs well above approvals. USCIS approved 311 new H-1B petitions in FY2026 and 376 continuing ones, counted by the employer's address.

DOL certified 213 PERM applications, the employer's step toward an employment-based green card, for jobs in the state in FY2025. In FY2024, 20% were for workers still on F-1 student visas (U.S. 8.7%): the most direct link from classroom to permanent residence.

1.71K

Certified H-1B positions (worksite), 2025

U.S. **914K** · **39th** of 51 · +14% since 2015

213

PERM green-card certifications, 2025

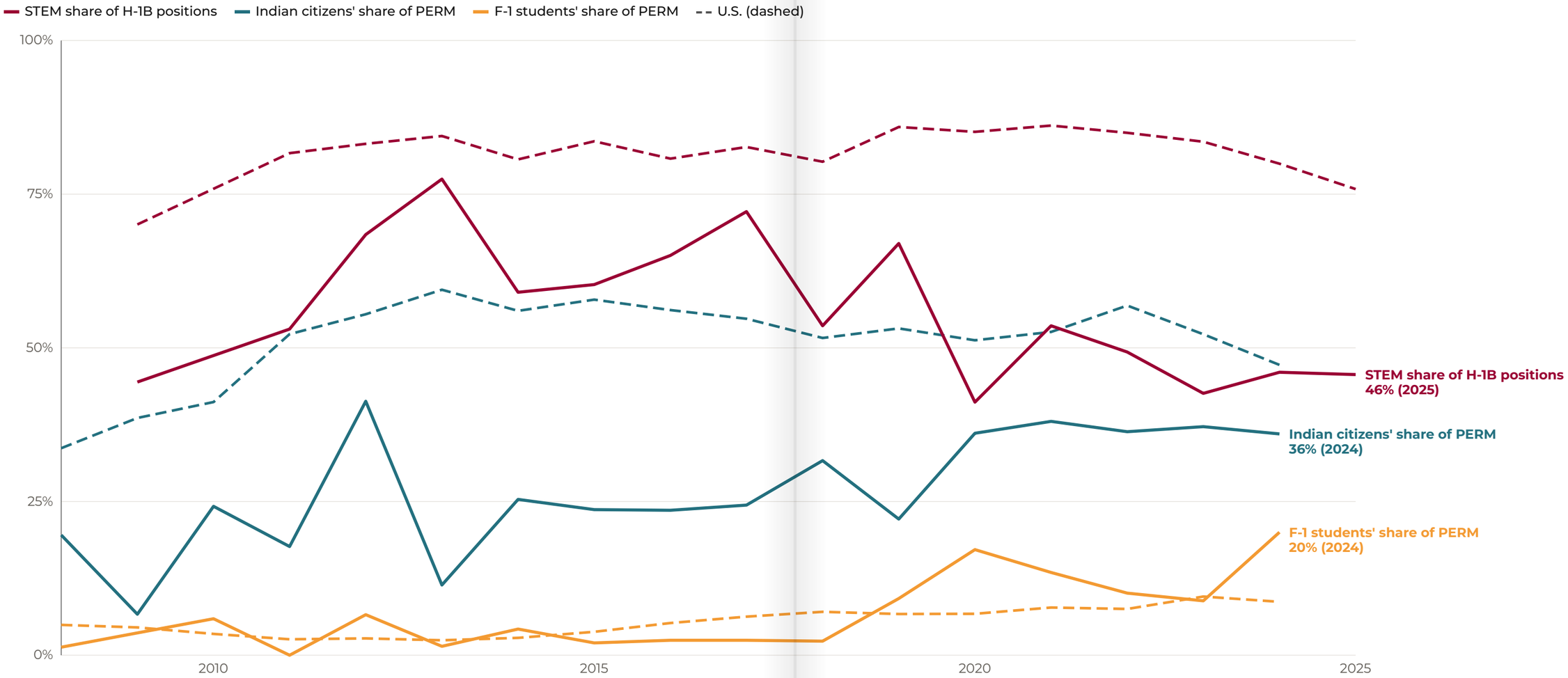
U.S. **138K** · **42nd** of 51 · +40% since 2015

20%

PERM workers on F-1 student visas, 2024

U.S. **8.7%** · **4th** of 51 · +18.0 pp since 2015

Figure 19 Who Holds New Mexico's Skilled-Visa Jobs?



State solid, U.S. dashed. PERM citizenship and class of admission are not on the form DOL uses from FY2025. Data from DOL, Office of Foreign Labor Certification.

46% of the state's certified H-1B positions were in STEM occupations in FY2025 (U.S. 76%).

Citizens of India held 36% of the state's PERM certifications in FY2024 (U.S. 47%). Under per-country caps they face the longest waits for a green card, so this share measures the state's exposure to the backlog.

46%

STEM share of H-1B positions, 2025

U.S. **76%** · **42nd** of 51 · −14.6 pp since 2015

36%

PERM certifications for Indian citizens, 2024

U.S. **47%** · **27th** of 51 · +12.3 pp since 2015

$90.3K

Median offered H-1B wage (nominal), 2025

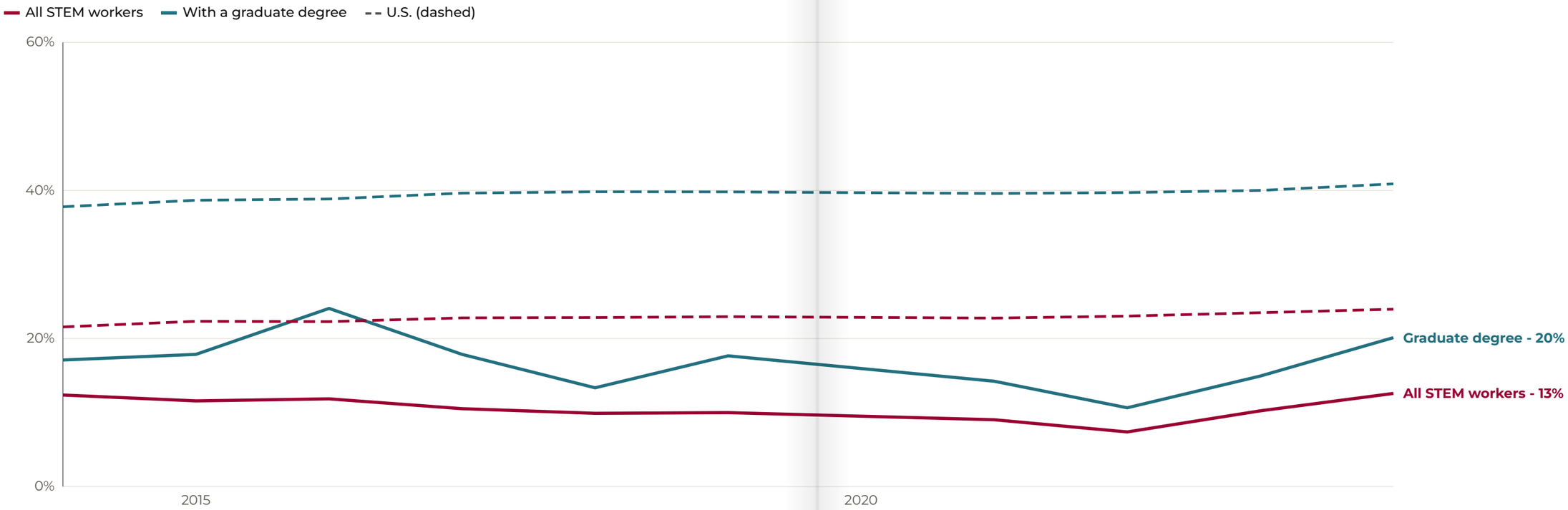
U.S. **$119K** · **41st** of 51 · +35% since 2015

SECTION 9

STEM Workforce

New Mexico ranks 36th of 44 on the foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree, at 20% in 2024 against 41% for the U.S.

Figure 20 How Much of New Mexico's STEM Workforce Was Born Abroad?



Foreign-born share of employed workers in STEM occupations, by state of residence; state solid, U.S. dashed. Shares resting on fewer than 100 survey records are left out. No 2020 (experimental data). Data from U.S. Census Bureau, American Community Survey.

In 2024, 13% of the people working in STEM occupations in New Mexico were born abroad (U.S. 24%; 28th of 51).

The share rises with education: 20% of STEM workers with a graduate degree were foreign-born (U.S. 41%). 6.4% of all STEM workers were not U.S. citizens.

13%

Foreign-born share of STEM workers, 2024

U.S. **24%** · **28th** of 51 · +1.0 pp since 2015

20%

Foreign-born, STEM workers with grad degrees, 2024

U.S. **41%** · **36th** of 44 · +2.3 pp since 2015

6.4%

Noncitizen share of STEM workers, 2024

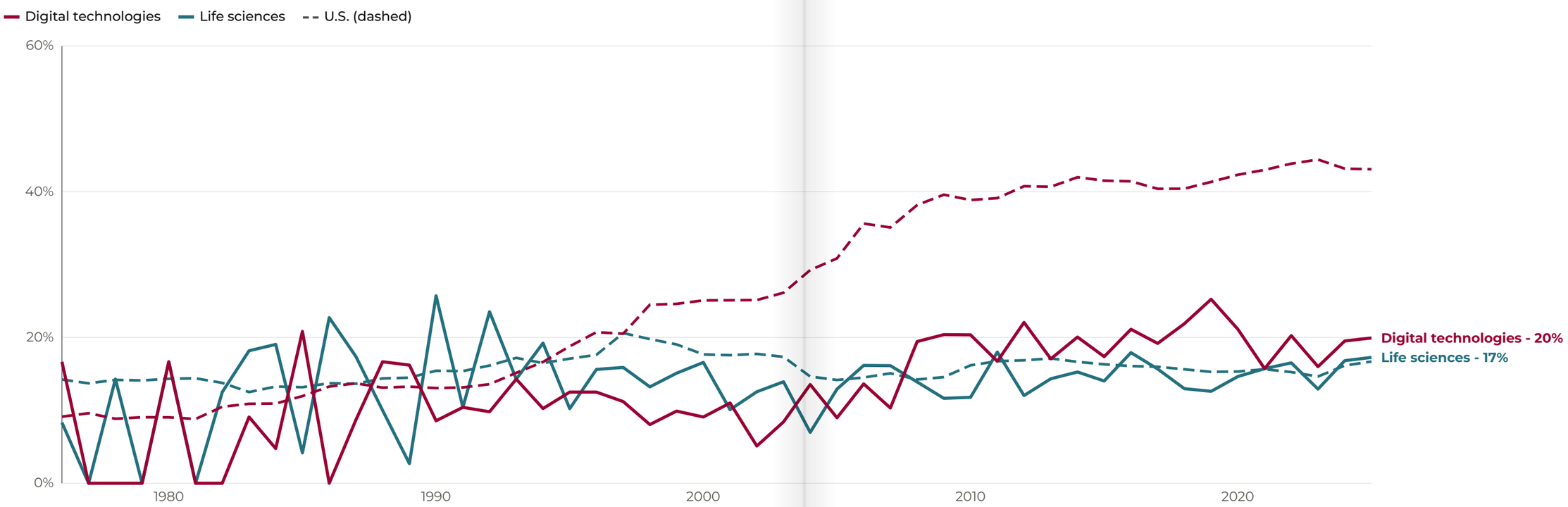
U.S. **11%** · **28th** of 51 · +1.8 pp since 2015

SECTION 10

Patents

New Mexico ranks 35th of 51 on patents granted to assignees in the state, at 320 in 2025 against 135K for the U.S.

Figure 21 What Kinds of Technology Does New Mexico Patent?



Share of patents granted to owners in the state, by WIPO technology field of the first classification; state solid, U.S. dashed. Fractional counts by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live. Data from USPTO, PatentsView.

Organizations and people in New Mexico were granted 320 U.S. patents in 2025, 0.2% of all patents with a U.S. owner (35th of 51).

20% were in digital technologies (U.S. 43%) and 17% in the life sciences (U.S. 17%).

320

Patents granted to owners in the state, 2025

U.S. **135K** · **35th** of 51 · +3.6% since 2015

20%

Patents in digital technologies, 2025

U.S. **43%** · **30th** of 51 · +2.6 pp since 2015

17%

Patents in life sciences, 2025

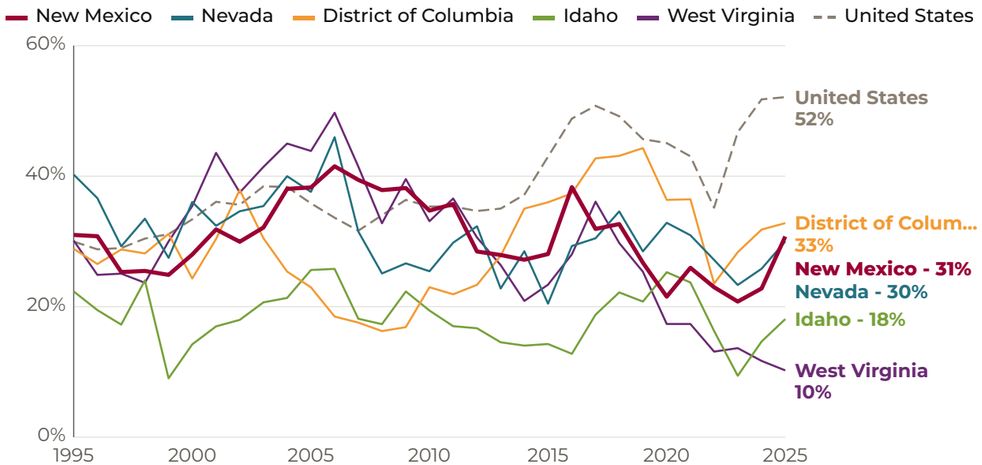
U.S. **17%** · **24th** of 51 · +3.2 pp since 2015

SECTION 11

Competitors

The four states closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally (a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size), are Nevada, District of Columbia, Idaho, and West Virginia. New Mexico ranks 2nd of the five on the international share of STEM master's; District of Columbia is the most dependent at 33%.

Figure 22 How Dependent Are New Mexico and Its Peers on International STEM Master's?



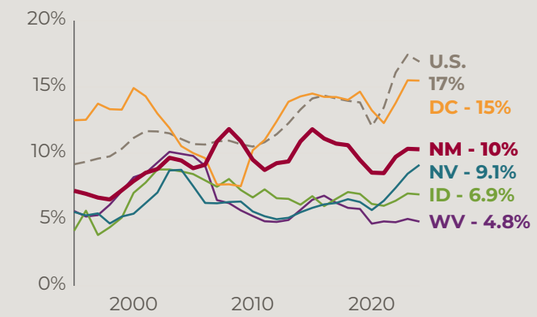
Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Table 4 How Does New Mexico Compare With States of Similar Size?

Measure	NM	NV	DC	ID	WV	U.S.
Students enrolled, 2024	**114K**	121K	100K	136K	137K	19.7M
Graduate share of students, 2024	**13%**	10%	42%	7.0%	16%	17%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025	**22%**	20%	16%	22%	16%	24%
STEM share of master's, 2025	**24%**	15%	17%	18%	10%	23%
International STEM master's, 2025	**237**	117	656	78	76	117K
Share of U.S. international STEM master's, 2025	**0.2%**	0.1%	0.6%	0.1%	0.1%	–
Int. share of STEM master's, 2025	**31%**	30%	33%	18%	10%	52%
Int. share of STEM research doctorates, 2025	**34%**	48%	36%	32%	43%	43%
Int. share of grad students, 2024	**10%**	9.1%	15%	6.9%	4.8%	17%
Int. share of undergraduate enrollment, 2024	**1.7%**	0.8%	5.6%	2.1%	1.7%	3.0%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024	**50%**	54%	79%	53%	53%	65%
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023	**$7.98K**	$6.6K	$6.33K	$8.18K	$9.14K	$9.71K
Appropriations per student, 2024	**$23K**	$10.8K	$44K	$11K	$10.3K	$11.4K
Average faculty salary, 2024	**$84.6K**	$110K	$132K	$81.4K	$76.4K	$106K
First-time students from in state, 2024	**85%**	91%	10%	54%	58%	–
Net migration per 100 residents, 2024	**−5**	−18	+162	+19	+36	–

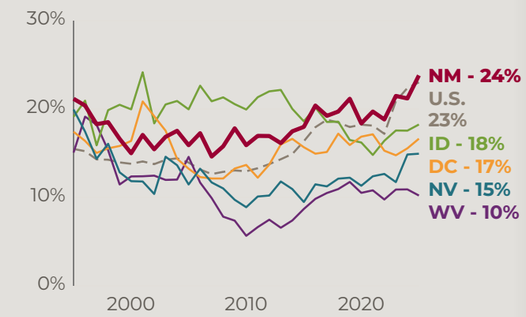
Latest year for each measure, given after its name. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 23 Int. share of grad students



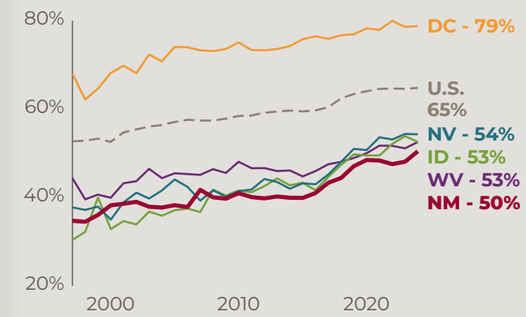
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 24 STEM share of master's



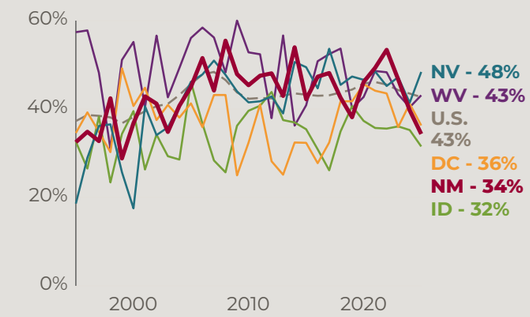
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 25 Six-year graduation rate



Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 26 Int. share of STEM doctorates

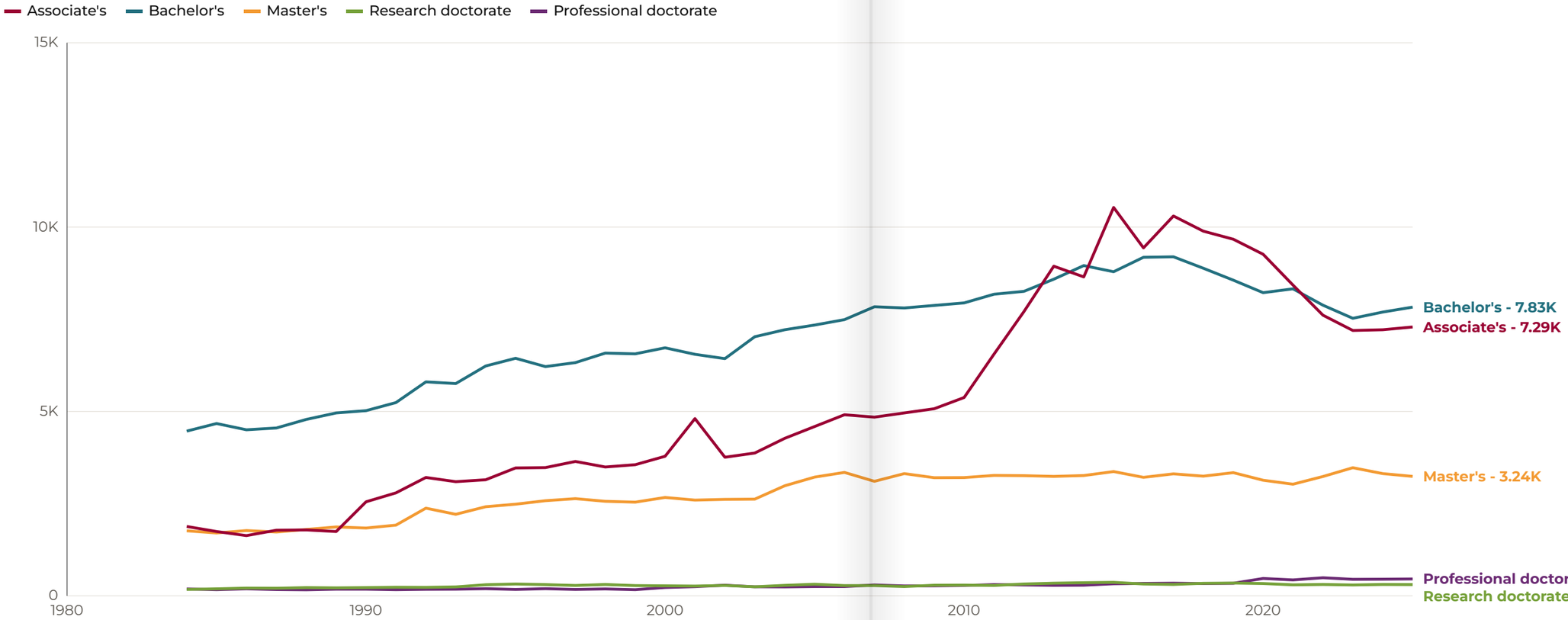


Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 12

Fields of Study

Figure 27 How Many Degrees Does New Mexico Award?

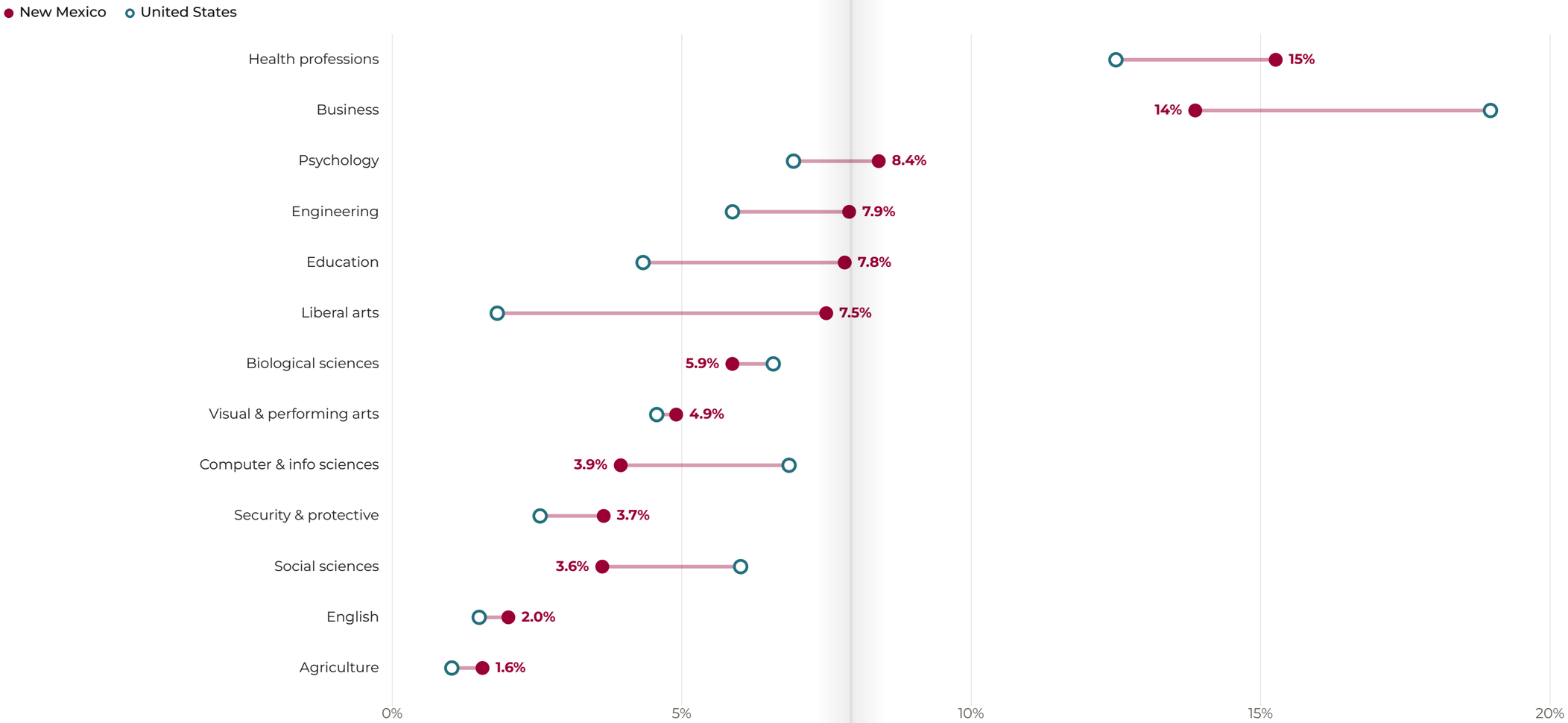


Degrees awarded by level, first majors. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

In 2025, New Mexico's institutions awarded 7.29K associate's degrees, 7.83K bachelor's degrees, 3.24K master's degrees, 303 research doctorate degrees, 457 professional doctorate degrees.

Since 2015: associate's down 31%; bachelor's down 11%; master's down 4%; research doctorate down 17%; professional doctorate up 39%. The state awards 7.9 bachelor's degrees for every 100 undergraduates (U.S. 12.3).

Figure 28 What Do New Mexico's Bachelor's Graduates Study?



Share of bachelor's degrees by field, 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

New Mexico's largest bachelor's fields are health professions (15%; U.S. 13%), business (14%; U.S. 19%), psychology (8.4%; U.S. 6.9%).

Relative to the nation, New Mexico's bachelor's degrees are most concentrated in liberal arts (4.14× the U.S. share), education (1.80× the U.S. share), agriculture (1.52× the U.S. share).

3.9%

Bachelor's in computer science, 2025

U.S. **6.9%** · **39th** of 51 · +1.7 pp since 2015

8.6%

Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025

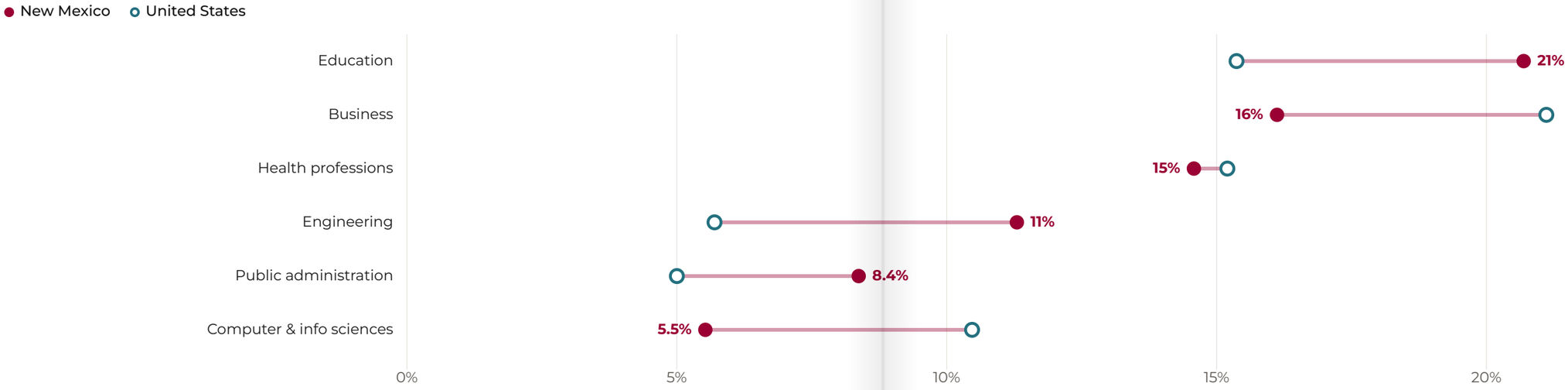
U.S. **6.8%** · **8th** of 51 · +0.3 pp since 2015

14%

Bachelor's in business, 2025

U.S. **19%** · **49th** of 51 · −2.6 pp since 2015

Figure 29 What Do New Mexico's Master's Graduates Study?



Share of master's degrees by field, 2025; largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

New Mexico's largest master's fields are education (21%; U.S. 15%), business (16%; U.S. 21%), health professions (15%; U.S. 15%).

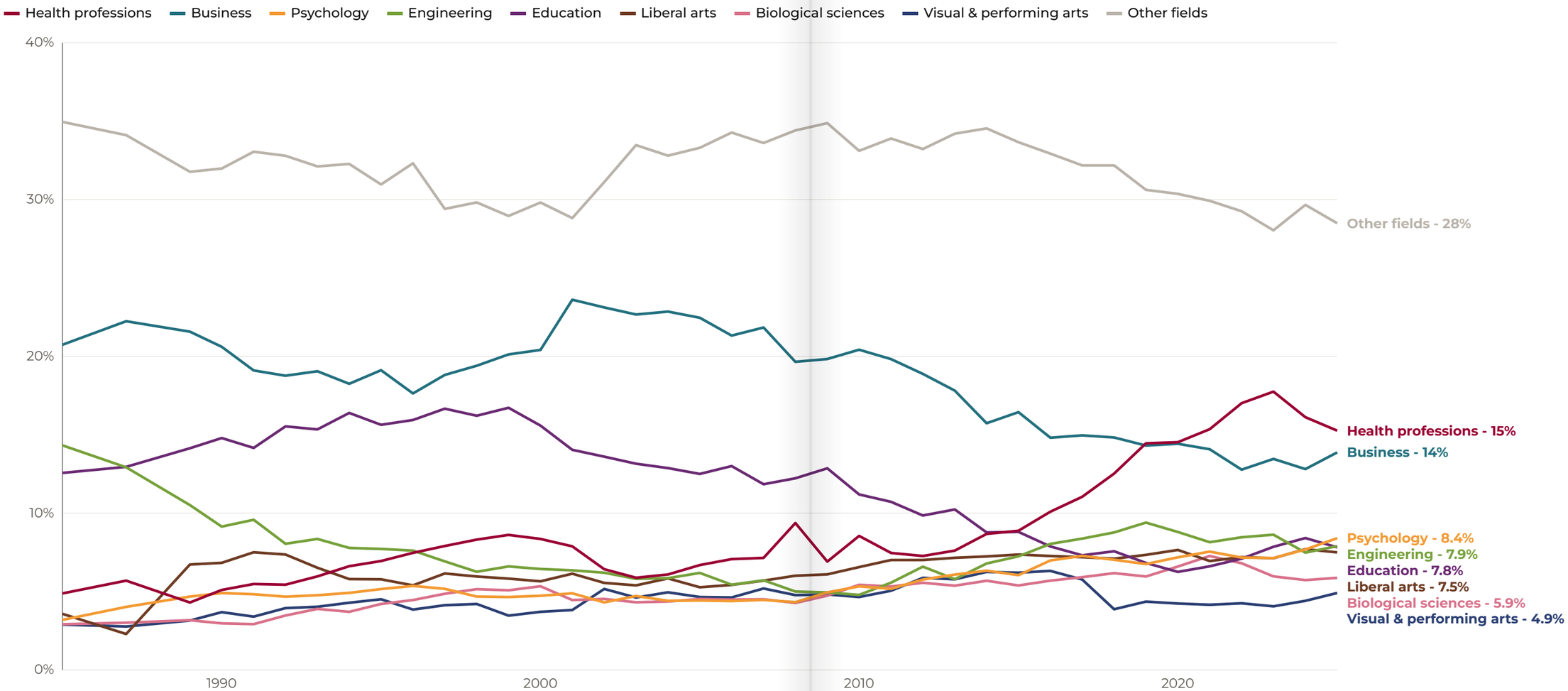
International students earn 11% of all master's degrees in the state (U.S. 22%), and STEM fields account for 24% of them.

24%
STEM share of master's, 2025
U.S. **23%** · **18th** of 51 · +5.8 pp since 2015

11%
Int. share of all master's, 2025
U.S. **22%** · **35th** of 51 · +2.2 pp since 2015

30%
Int. share of CS master's, 2025
U.S. **65%** · **41st** of 47 · −6.9 pp since 2015

Figure 30 How Has New Mexico's Bachelor's Field Mix Changed?



Share of bachelor's degrees in the largest fields. Data from NCES, IPEDS Completions.

Since 2015, health professions has gained the most ground, 6.4 points of the state's bachelor's degrees, while business lost the most (2.6 points).

The chart follows the share of bachelor's degrees in each of the state's largest fields; smaller fields are grouped as other fields.

SECTION 12 · FIELDS OF STUDY

Where Is New Mexico Most Specialized?

The location quotient divides a field's share of New Mexico's bachelor's degrees by its share of all U.S. bachelor's degrees in 2025. A quotient of 1.00 means the same share as the nation; 2.00 means twice the national share. The table lists the 10 fields with the highest quotients among fields with at least 50 degrees.

Highest location quotients. Liberal arts (4.14, with 7.5% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.8% for the U.S.), education (1.80, with 7.8% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 4.3% for the U.S.), and agriculture (1.52, with 1.6% of the state's bachelor's degrees against 1.0% for the U.S.) had the highest quotients.

Table 5 Where Is New Mexico Most Specialized?

Field	Location quotient	State share	U.S. share	Degrees
Liberal arts	**4.14**	7.5%	1.8%	587
Education	**1.80**	7.8%	4.3%	612
Agriculture	**1.52**	1.6%	1.0%	122
Security & protective	**1.43**	3.7%	2.6%	286
Engineering	**1.34**	7.9%	5.9%	618
English	**1.34**	2.0%	1.5%	157
Health professions	**1.22**	15%	13%	1.2K
Psychology	**1.21**	8.4%	6.9%	658
Visual & performing arts	**1.07**	4.9%	4.6%	384
Physical sciences	**1.01**	1.3%	1.3%	102

Bachelor's degrees; location quotient = state share ÷ U.S. share; fields with 50+ degrees. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

22%
STEM share of bachelor's, 2025
U.S. **24%** · **30th** of 51

3.9%
Bachelor's in computer science, 2025
U.S. **6.9%** · **39th** of 51

8.6%
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology, 2025
U.S. **6.8%** · **8th** of 51

Engineering & eng. technology. The share was 8.6% in 2025, against 6.8% for the U.S., 8th among the states, up 0.3 points from 8.3% in 2024 and up 0.3 points since 2015, when it was 8.3%.

Health professions. The share was 15% in 2025, against 12% for the U.S., 11th among the states, down 0.9 points from 16% in 2024 and up 6.4 points since 2015, when it was 8.9%.

Table 6 New Mexico at a Glance

Measure	2015	Previous	Latest	Change	U.S.	Rank
STEM share of bachelor's	20%	21% 2024	**22% 2025**	+2.3 pp	24%	30th
Bachelor's in computer science	2.2%	3.3% 2024	**3.9% 2025**	+1.7 pp	6.9%	39th
Bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	8.3%	8.3% 2024	**8.6% 2025**	+0.3 pp	6.8%	8th
Bachelor's in business	16%	13% 2024	**14% 2025**	−2.6 pp	19%	49th

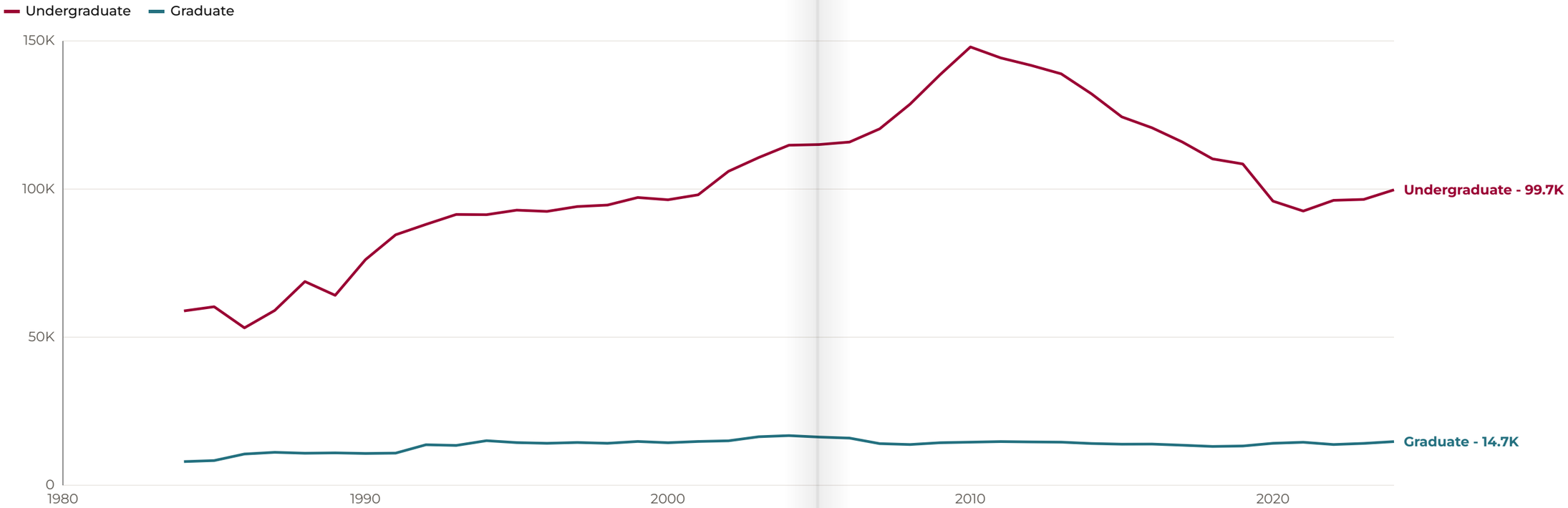
Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 13

Students and Money

New Mexico ranks 5th of 51 on the share of students enrolled part-time, at 50% in 2024 against 39% for the U.S.

Figure 31 How Has Enrollment Changed?



Fall headcount enrollment. Data from NCES, IPEDS Fall Enrollment.

In fall 2024, New Mexico enrolled 99.7K undergraduates and 14.7K graduate students, 114K in all (40th of 51).

Undergraduate enrollment is down 20% since 2015 and graduate enrollment up 6% since 2015. Graduate students are 13% of all students (U.S. 17%).

114K

Students enrolled, 2024

U.S. **19.7M** · **40th** of 51 · −17% since 2015

13%

Graduate share of students, 2024

U.S. **17%** · **40th** of 51 · +2.9 pp since 2015

50%

Students attending part-time, 2024

U.S. **39%** · **5th** of 51 · +1.6 pp since 2015

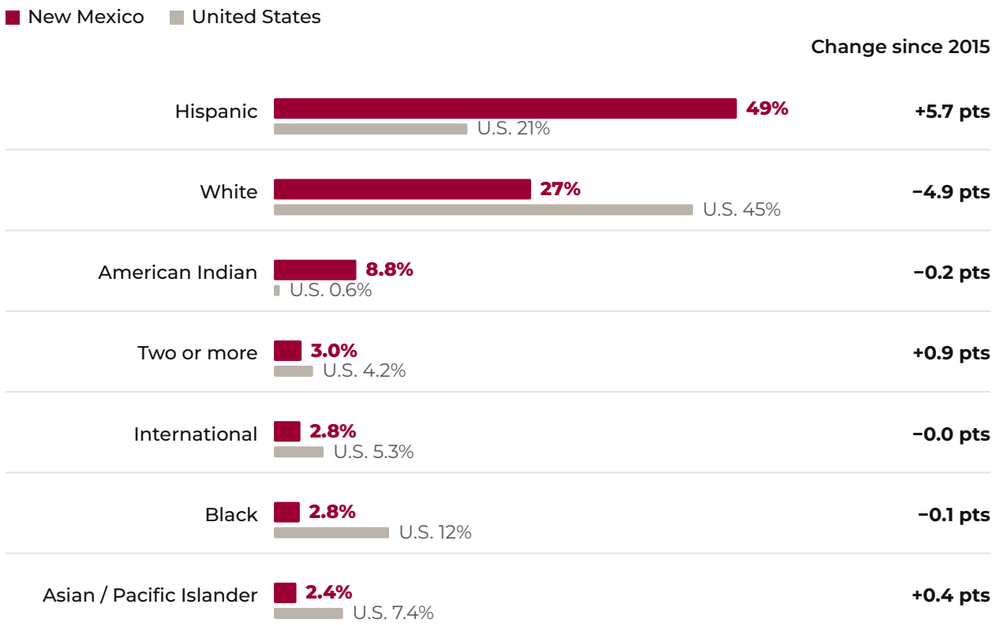
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

Who Enrolls in New Mexico, and Where?

In fall 2024, Hispanic students were the largest group at New Mexico's degree-granting institutions, **49%** of enrollment against 21% nationally, up 5.7 points since 2015.

White students were **27%** (U.S. 45%), down 4.9 points since 2015, and American Indian students were **8.8%** (U.S. 0.6%), down 0.2 points since 2015.

Figure 32 Who Enrolls in New Mexico?



Share of fall 2024 headcount enrollment by race and ethnicity; students of unknown race are left out of the chart. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

49%
Hispanic students
U.S. **21%** · +5.7 pp since 2015

27%
White students
U.S. **45%** · −4.9 pp since 2015

49%
At public 4-year institutions
+5.2 pp since 2015

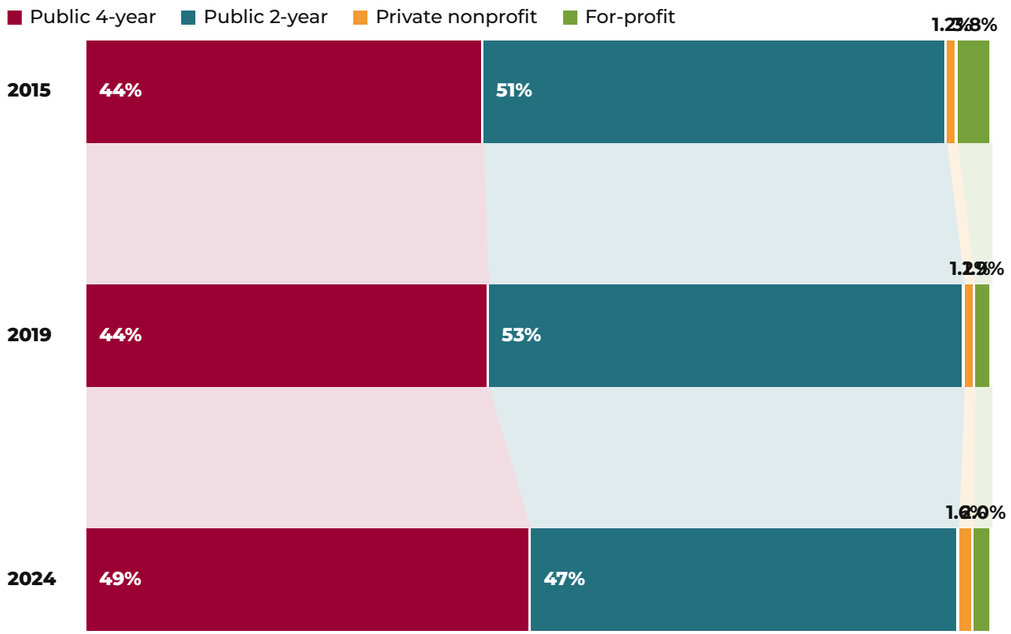
47%
At public 2-year institutions
−3.9 pp since 2015

In fall 2024, public 4-year institutions enrolled **49%** of students, up 5.2 points from 44% in 2015. Public 2-year institutions enrolled **47%** of students, down 3.9 points from 51% in 2015.

For-profit institutions enrolled **2.0%** of students, down 1.8 points from 3.8% in 2015, and private nonprofit institutions enrolled **1.6%** of students, up 0.5 points from 1.2% in 2015.

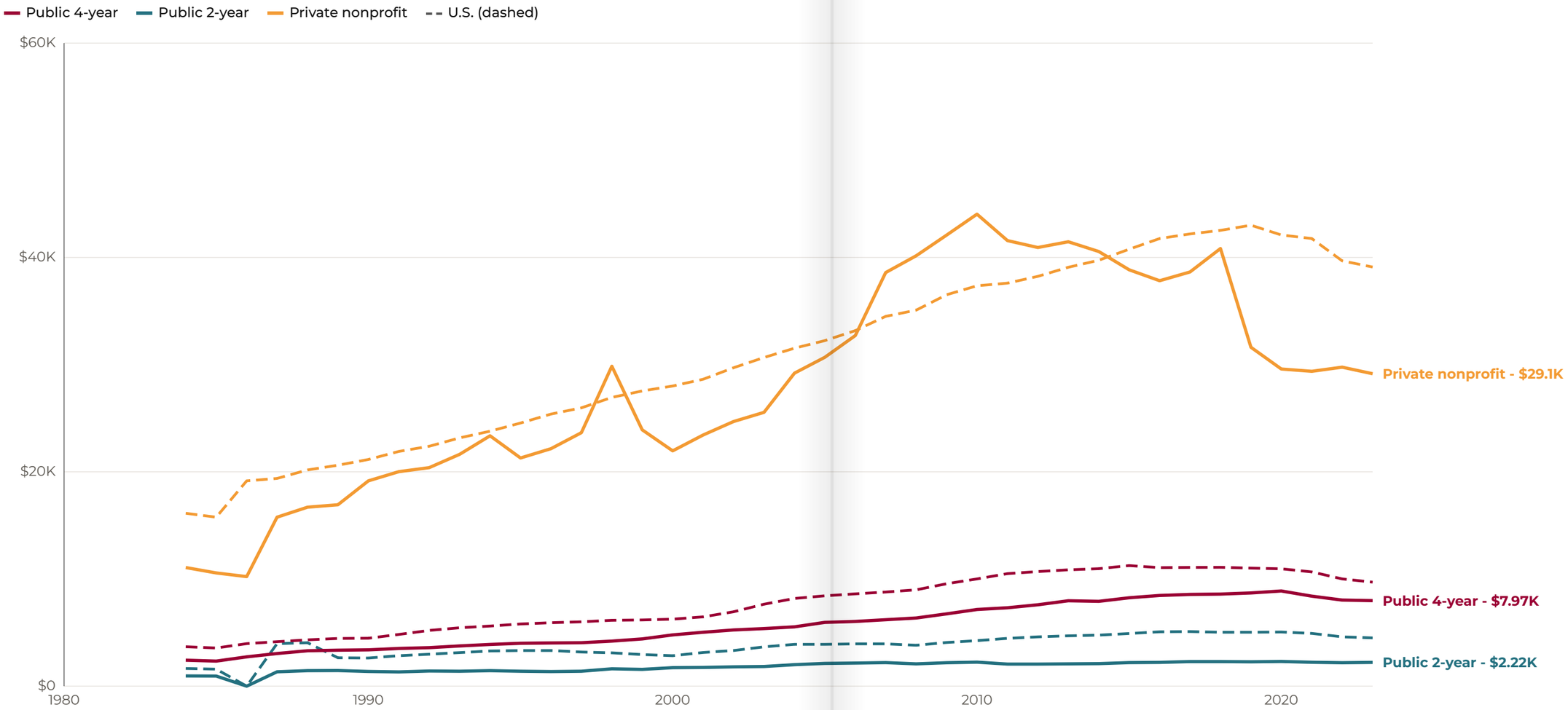
Public institutions together enrolled **96%** of students, against 73% nationally, 1st among the states.

Figure 33 Where Do Students Enroll?



Share of fall headcount enrollment by sector, 2015, 2019, 2024. Sectors as IPEDS classifies them each year. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

Figure 34 What Does In-State Tuition Cost?



Published in-state tuition and fees, 2024 dollars (CPI-U); state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

In-state tuition and fees at New Mexico's public four-year institutions are $7.98K (2023, 2024 dollars), 18% below the U.S. ($9.71K); the state ranks 43rd of 51.

State and local appropriations come to $23K per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions (3rd of 51), and net tuition makes up 14% of net tuition plus state and local appropriations (U.S. 43%).

$7.98K

In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023

U.S. **$9.71K** · **43rd** of 51 · −3.3% since 2015

$23K

Appropriations per student, 2024

U.S. **$11.4K** · **3rd** of 51 · +69% since 2015

14%

Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024

U.S. **43%** · **51st** of 51 · −10.1 pp since 2015

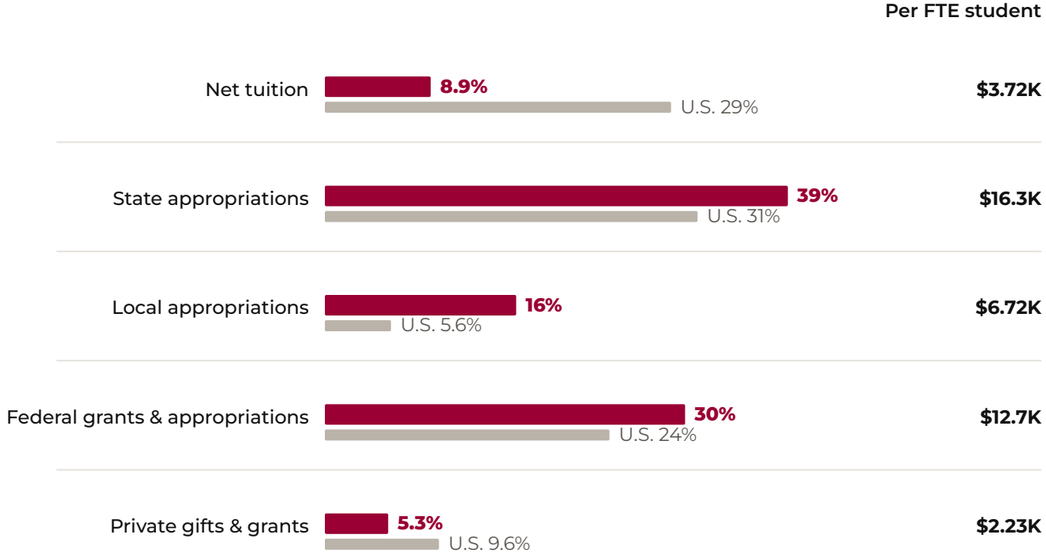
SECTION 13 · STUDENTS AND MONEY

How Are New Mexico's Public Institutions Funded, and What Do They Produce?

The bars give each source's share of the core revenue of New Mexico's public institutions, with the nation for comparison, and at right the dollars per full-time-equivalent (FTE) student it provides. Values are in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Net tuition is tuition and fees after institutional discounts and allowances.

Net tuition per FTE student. The figure was $3.72K in FY2024, against $8.96K for the U.S., down 7.4% from $4.02K in FY2023 and down 13% since FY2015, when it was $4.29K.

Figure 35 How Are Public Institutions Funded?



Share of core revenue per FTE student by source, public institutions, FY2024; dollars per FTE at right, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Shares are of all five sources; the tuition share elsewhere in this profile divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations only. Data from NCES, IPEDS Finance.

$7.98K
In-state tuition, public 4-year, 2023
U.S. **$9.71K** · **43rd** of 51

$23K
Appropriations per student, 2024
U.S. **$11.4K** · **3rd** of 51

14%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations, 2024
U.S. **43%** · **51st** of 51

50%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **50th** of 51

The table brings together five measures of what public higher education costs and what it produces in New Mexico: in-state tuition at public four-year institutions, state and local appropriations per full-time-equivalent student, tuition's share of public institutions' core revenue, the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, and the average full-time faculty salary.

In-state tuition, public 4-year. The figure was $7.98K in 2023, against $9.71K for the U.S., 43rd among the states, down 0.8% from $8.04K in 2022 and down 3.3% since 2015, when it was $8.25K.

Table 7 Money and Results

Measure	Year	New Mexico	U.S.	Rank	Change since 2015
In-state tuition, public 4-year	2023	**$7.98K**	$9.71K	43rd of 51	−3.3%
Appropriations per student	2024	**$23K**	$11.4K	3rd of 51	+69%
Tuition share of tuition plus appropriations	2024	**14%**	43%	51st of 51	−10.1 pp
Six-year graduation rate	2024	**50%**	65%	50th of 51	+10.5 pp
Average faculty salary	2024	**$84.6K**	$106K	39th of 51	−3.0%

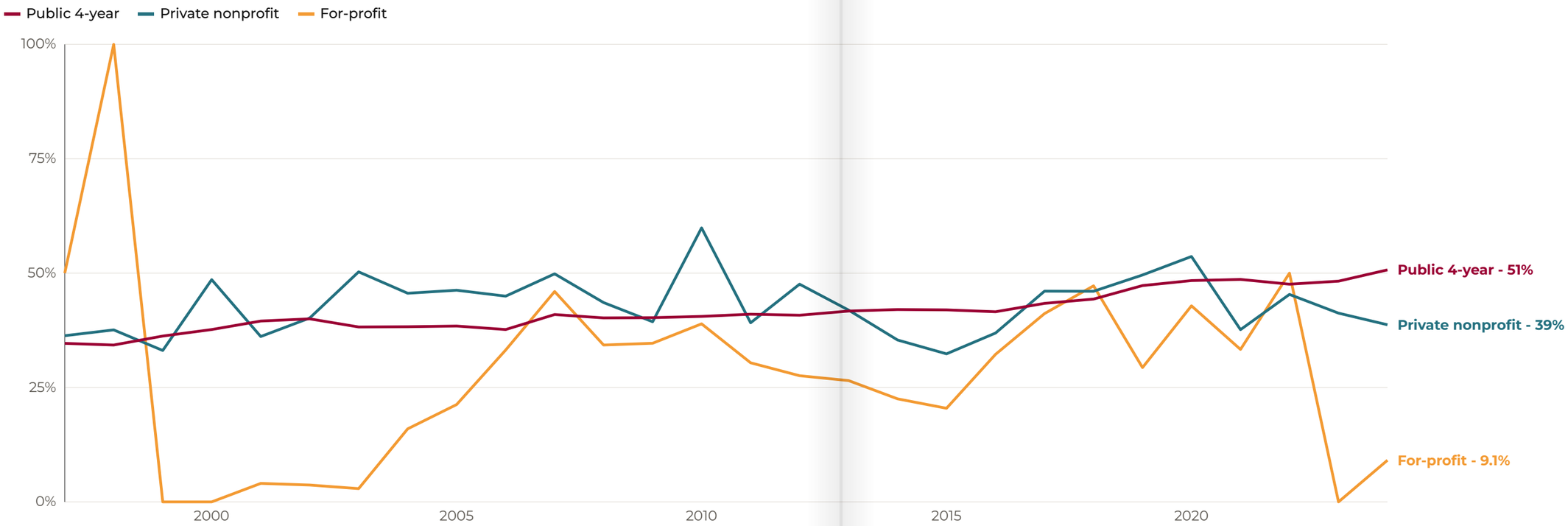
Rank among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). Dollars in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 14

Student Outcomes

New Mexico ranks 50th of 51 on the six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions, at 50% in 2024 against 65% for the U.S.

Figure 36 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Sector?



Six-year bachelor's graduation rate by sector of institution. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

50% of students who started a bachelor's degree at a four-year institution in New Mexico graduated within six years (2024), 14.4 points below the U.S. (65%); the state ranks 50th of 51.

By sector: public 4-year 51%, private nonprofit 39%, for-profit 9.1%. At two-year institutions, 34% complete within 150% of normal time (U.S. 41%).

50%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **50th** of 51 · +10.5 pp since 2015

34%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **38th** of 50 · +10.7 pp since 2015

7.9
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **49th** of 51 · +1.2 since 2015

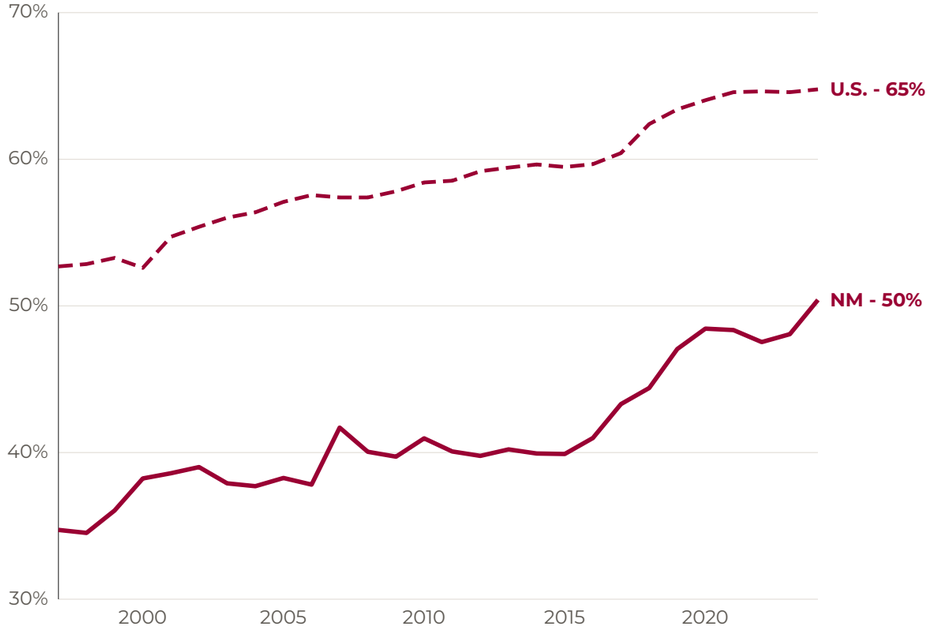
SECTION 14 · STUDENT OUTCOMES

How Many of New Mexico's Students Graduate?

The line follows the share of first-time, full-time bachelor's-degree students at New Mexico's four-year institutions who graduated from the institution where they started within six years (150% of normal time). Each year is the cohort that entered six years earlier. The rate leaves out students who start part-time (50% of the state's students attend part-time, against 39% nationally) and students who transfer and finish elsewhere. The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Six-year graduation rate. The rate was 50% in 2024, against 65% for the U.S., up 2.3 points from 48% in 2023 and up 10.5 points since 2015, when it was 40%.

Figure 37 Six-Year Bachelor's Graduation Rate



Four-year institutions; state solid, U.S. dashed. Data from NCES, IPEDS Graduation Rates.

50%
Six-year graduation rate, 2024
U.S. **65%** · **50th** of 51

34%
Two-year completion rate, 2024
U.S. **41%** · **38th** of 50

7.9
Bachelor's per 100 undergraduates, 2025
U.S. **12.3** · **49th** of 51

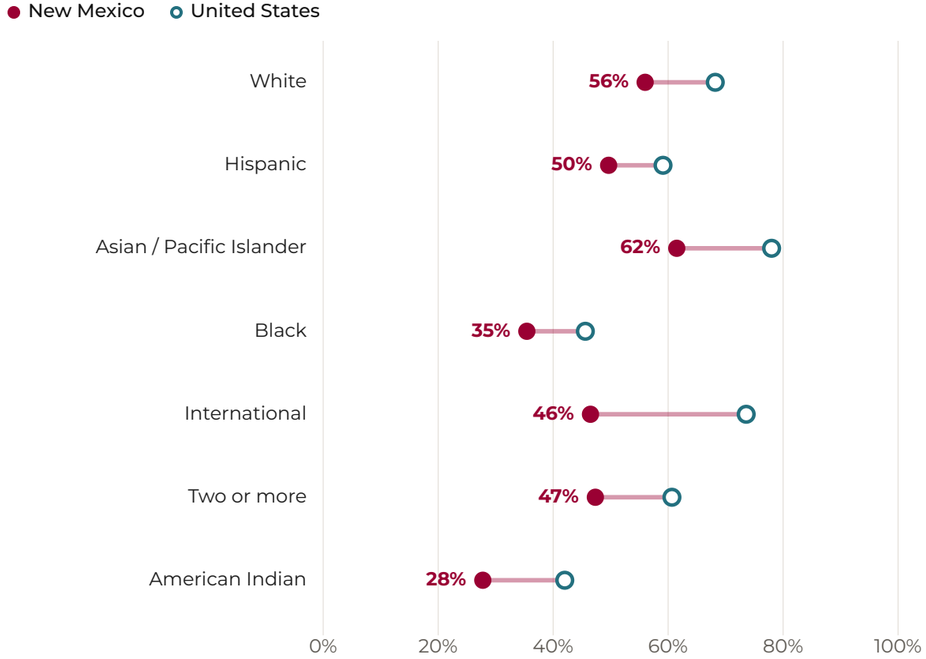
Each row is the six-year bachelor's graduation rate for one racial or ethnic group of students at New Mexico's four-year institutions (filled dot), against the national rate for the same group (open dot). Groups with fewer than 100 students in the cohort are left out.

White. The six-year rate was 56% in 2024, against 68% for the U.S.

Hispanic. The six-year rate was 50% in 2024, against 59% for the U.S.

Asian / Pacific Islander. The six-year rate was 62% in 2024, against 78% for the U.S.

Figure 38 How Do Graduation Rates Differ by Race and Ethnicity?



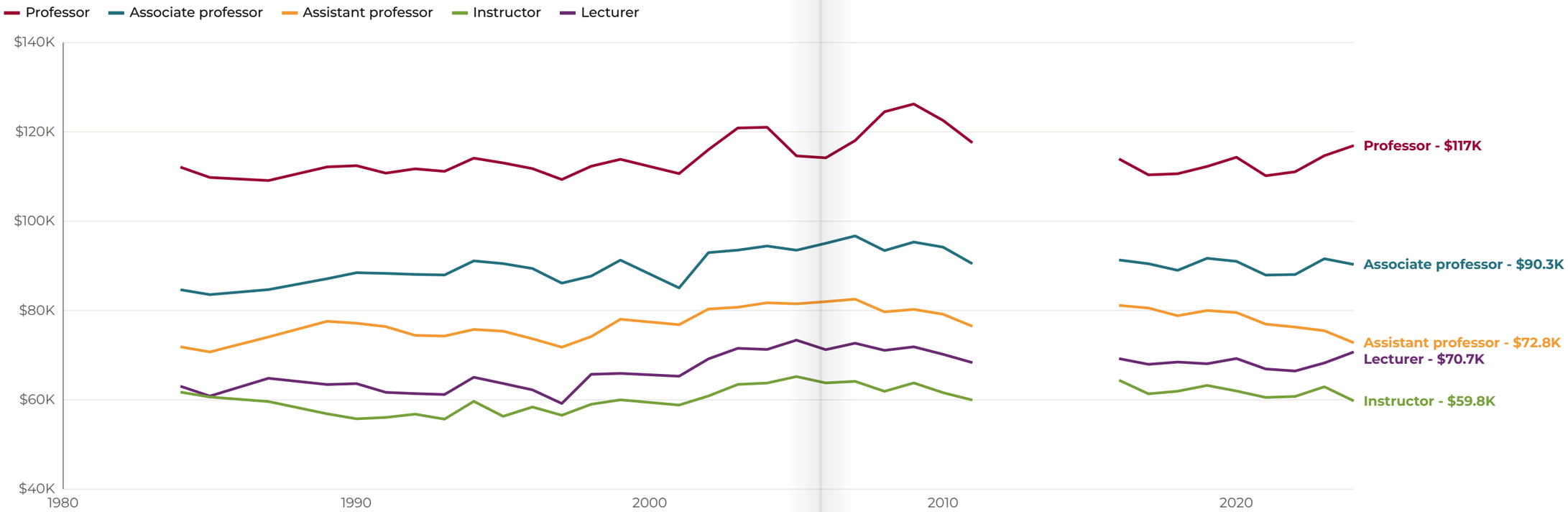
Six-year rate, 2024; groups with 100+ students. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 15

Faculty

New Mexico ranks 39th of 51 on the average full-time faculty salary, at $84.6K in 2024 against $106K for the U.S.

Figure 39 What Do New Mexico's Faculty Earn, by Rank?



Average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts, by academic rank, 2024 dollars (CPI-U). Data from NCES, IPEDS Human Resources.

Full-time instructional faculty on 9/10-month contracts at New Mexico's institutions earned an average of $84.6K in 2024 (2024 dollars), 20% below the U.S. ($106K); the state ranks 39th of 51. By rank (2024): professors $117K, associate professors $90.3K, assistant professors $72.8K, instructors $59.8K, lecturers $70.7K.

New Mexico's institutions had 4.84K full-time instructional staff in 2024, up 7% since 2015. Average salary across all ranks is down 3% since 2016.

$84.6K

Average faculty salary, 2024

U.S. **$106K** · **39th** of 51 · −3.0% since 2016

SECTION 15 · FACULTY

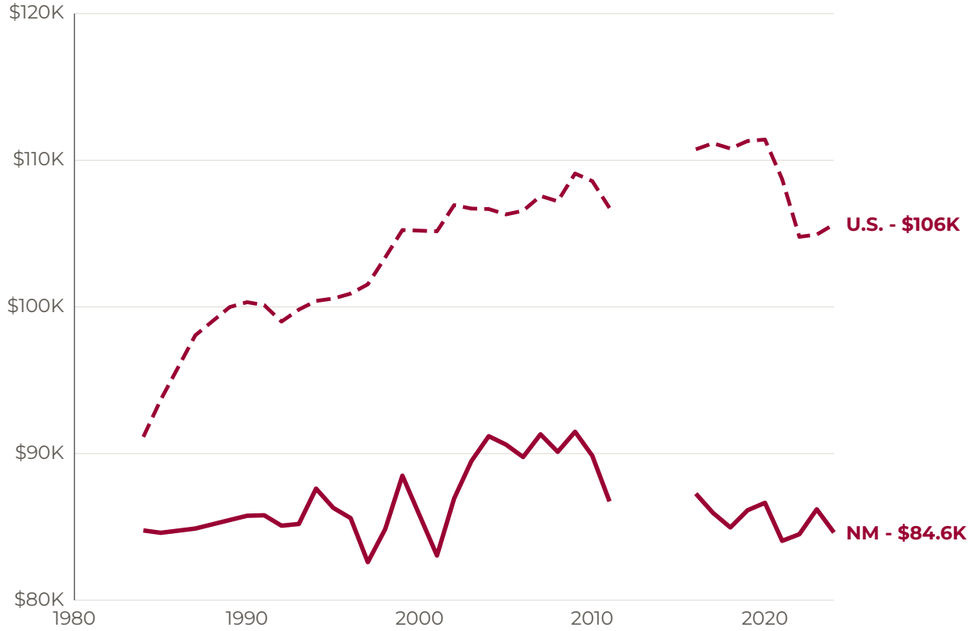
What Do New Mexico's Faculty Earn, and How Many Hold Tenure?

The line follows the average salary of full-time instructional faculty on 9- or 10-month contracts at New Mexico's degree-granting institutions, all ranks combined, in 2024 dollars (CPI-U). The state is solid and the United States dashed.

Average salary. The figure was $84.6K in 2024, against $106K for the U.S., 39th among the states, down 1.8% from $86.2K in 2023 and down 3.0% since 2016, when it was $87.3K.

Full-time instructional staff. The number was 4.84K in 2024, up 3.6% from 4.67K in 2023 and up 7.0% since 2015, when it was 4.52K.

Figure 40 Average Faculty Salary



Full-time instructional faculty, 9/10-month, 2024 dollars. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

$84.6K
Average faculty salary, 2024
U.S. **$106K** · **39th** of 51

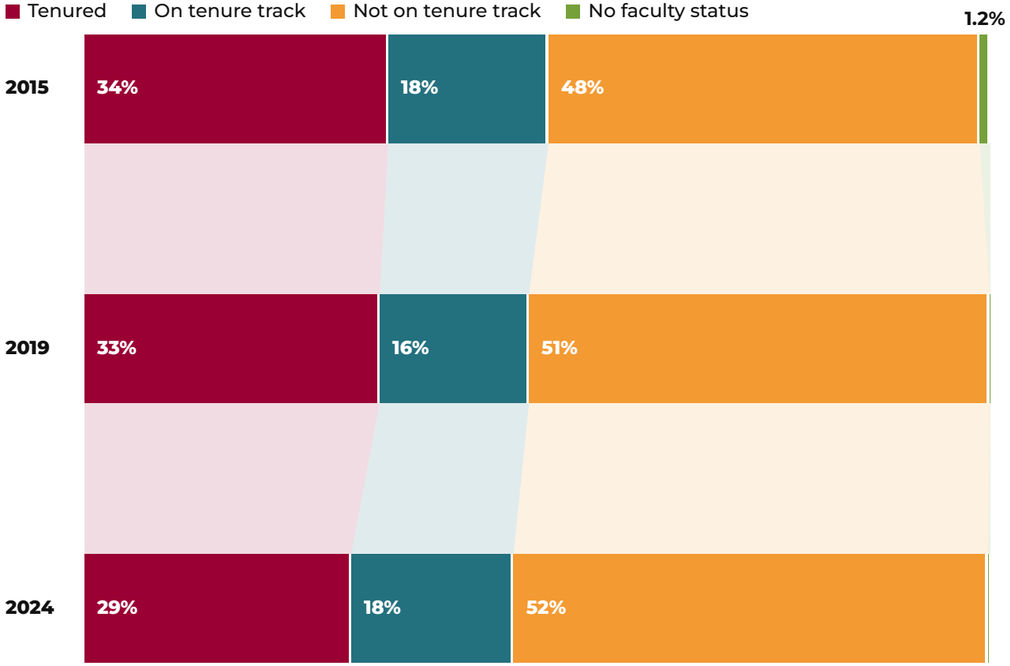
4.84K
Full-time instructional staff, 2024

29%
Tenured, 2024

The bars divide New Mexico's full-time instructional staff by tenure status in 2015, 2019 and 2024: tenured, on the tenure track, not on the tenure track (for example, lecturers on fixed-term contracts), and staff at institutions with no tenure system.

Tenured, share of full-time instructional staff. The share was 29% in 2024, down 1.5 points from 31% in 2023 and down 4.1 points since 2015, when it was 34%.

Figure 41 Tenure Status



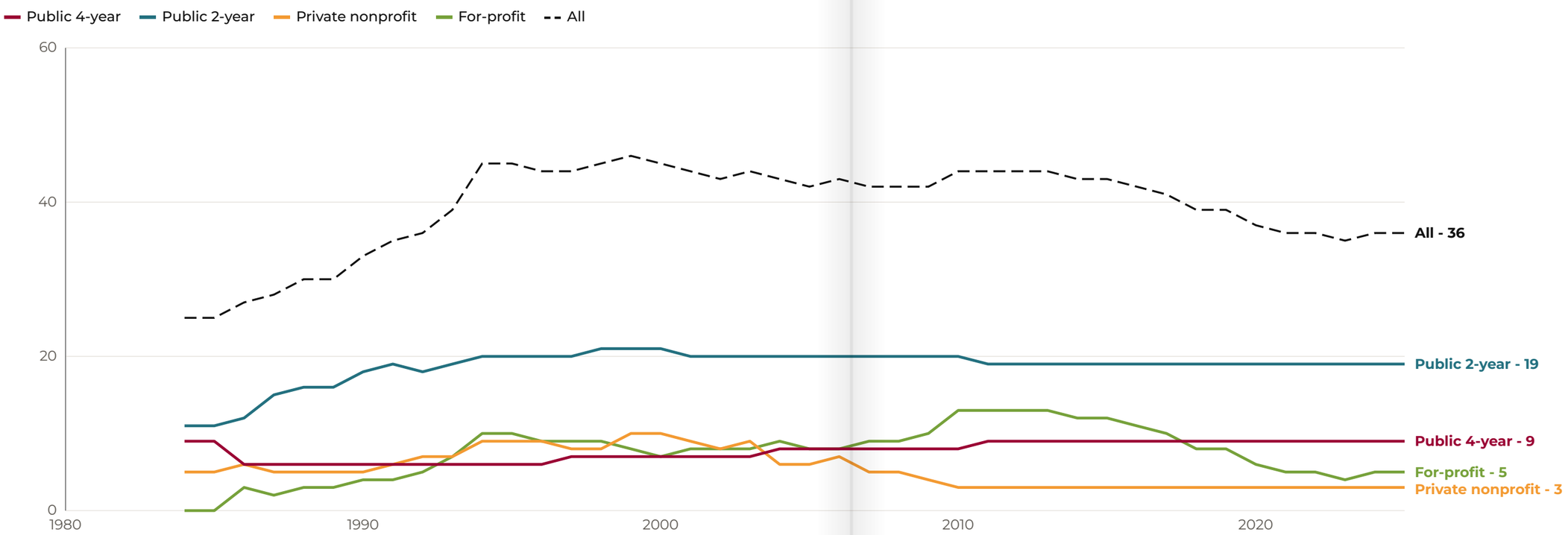
Full-time instructional staff by tenure status, 2015, 2019, 2024. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

SECTION 16

Institutions

New Mexico ranks 1st of 51 on the share of enrollment at public institutions, at 96% in 2024 against 73% for the U.S.

Figure 42 How Many Institutions Does New Mexico Have?



Degree-granting institutions by sector. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

New Mexico has 36 degree-granting institutions:9 public 4-year, 19 public 2-year, 3 private nonprofit, 5 for-profit (2025).

The number of institutions is down 16% since 2015. 96% of students attend public institutions and 2.0% attend for-profit ones.

96%

Students at public institutions, 2024

U.S. **73%** · **1st** of 51 · +1.3 pp since 2015

2.0%

Students at for-profit institutions, 2024

U.S. **5.5%** · **25th** of 51 · −1.8 pp since 2015

31%

Students fully online, 2024

U.S. **27%** · **12th** of 51 · +14.4 pp since 2015

SECTION 16 · INSTITUTIONS

Which Institutions Lead in New Mexico?

The table ranks institutions in New Mexico by the STEM master's degrees and research doctorates they awarded to international students in 2025, the two counted together. The share columns give international students' share of each institution's STEM degrees at that level.

Largest. University of New Mexico-Main Campus (107 international STEM master's degrees and 20 doctorates), New Mexico State University-Main Campus (92 international STEM master's degrees and 33 doctorates), and New Mexico Institute of Mining and Technology (31 international STEM master's degrees and 2 doctorates) awarded the most.

Table 8 Which Institutions Train the Most International STEM Graduates?

Institution	Intl STEM master's	Int. share	Intl STEM doctorates	Int. share
University of New Mexico-Main Campus Albuquerque · Public 4-year	**107**	29%	20	26%
New Mexico State University-Main Campus Las Cruces · Public 4-year	**92**	36%	33	52%
New Mexico Institute of Mining and Technology Socorro · Public 4-year	**31**	31%	2	11%
Eastern New Mexico University-Main Campus Portales · Public 4-year	**5**	83%	–	–
New Mexico Highlands University Las Vegas · Public 4-year	**2**	13%	–	–

Degrees awarded in 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

36
Degree-granting institutions, 2025

96%
Students at public institutions, 2024
U.S. **73%** · **1st** of 51

2.0%
Students at for-profit institutions, 2024
U.S. **5.5%** · **25th** of 51

31%
Students fully online, 2024
U.S. **27%** · **12th** of 51

The table lists New Mexico's largest degree-granting institutions by fall 2024 headcount enrollment, with the international share of graduate students, STEM bachelor's degrees awarded in 2025, the six-year graduation rate and the admission rate (a dash where the institution admits all applicants or does not report one).

Largest. The three largest were University of New Mexico-Main Campus (23.1K students), Central New Mexico Community College (19.3K students), and New Mexico State University-Main Campus (15.4K students).

Table 9 What Are New Mexico's Largest Institutions?

Institution	Enrollment	Int. share, grad	STEM bachelor's	Six-year grad rate	Admit rate
University of New Mexico-Main Campus	**23.1K**	12%	691	54%	95%
Central New Mexico Community College	**19.3K**	–	–	–	–
New Mexico State University-Main Campus	**15.4K**	19%	732	55%	89%
New Mexico State University-Dona Ana	**7.2K**	–	–	–	–
San Juan College	**6.45K**	–	–	–	–
Eastern New Mexico University-Main Campus	**5.72K**	3.3%	38	39%	92%
Santa Fe Community College	**4.47K**	–	–	–	–
Western New Mexico University	**3.53K**	3.5%	23	26%	–
New Mexico Highlands University	**2.7K**	3.5%	26	27%	–
Clovis Community College	**2.34K**	–	–	–	–

Fall 2024 enrollment; degrees 2025. Data from NCES, IPEDS.

NOTES

About These Data

International students

U.S. nonresidents on temporary visas, as IPEDS defines them. IPEDS does not record country of citizenship. Permanent residents count with U.S. citizens.

STEM

CIP families 03, 04, 11, 14, 15, 26, 27 and 40. Doctorates are research and scholarship doctorates; professional doctorates appear only in the degree-count figure. Degrees are first majors only.

Universe

Degree-granting institutions located in the state; Title IV participants from 1996. Geography is the institution's location, not the student's home. Enrollment is fall headcount.

Migration

First-time degree-seeking undergraduates by home state, reported in even years before 2001 and every year since; odd years with incomplete reporting are omitted. Net migration is students arriving from other states minus residents leaving, per 100 resident first-time students.

Money

Tuition, appropriations, revenue and faculty salaries are in 2024 dollars using the CPI-U. Research funding (HERD, Federal Funds, USAspending), wages and the NAFSA economic contribution are nominal dollars, and are labeled so. Appropriations and revenue are per full-time-equivalent student at public institutions; the tuition share divides net tuition by net tuition plus state and local appropriations.

Race and ethnicity

IPEDS did not collect race and ethnicity in every year before 2010, and categories changed in 2008–2010; “Two or more” exists only from then.

Countries of citizenship

From DHS SEVIS by the Numbers: active F-1 and M-1 student records in the month named, at every level from primary school to doctorate, by the state of the school. IPEDS records only whether a student is a U.S. nonresident, not where they come from. SEVIS counts are monthly snapshots and are not directly comparable with IPEDS fall enrollment or degree counts. Year-to-year comparisons use one fall snapshot per year (the month closest to November).

Peers

Comparison states are the four closest in total fall enrollment, measured proportionally: a state 1.5 times as large counts as near as one two-thirds the size.

Sources

IPEDS (National Center for Education Statistics) is the backbone: Institutional Characteristics, Fall Enrollment, Completions, Graduation Rates, Finance, Human Resources and Admissions, 1980–2025, harmonized into a state panel. The profile also draws on NAEP, NSF's Survey of Graduate Students and Postdoctorates, Survey of Earned Doctorates, HERD and Federal Funds surveys, USAspending.gov, DHS SEVIS by the Numbers and ICE SEVIS releases, the Department of Labor's Office of Foreign Labor Certification and BLS wage data, the USCIS H-1B Employer Data Hub, the Census Bureau's American Community Survey and Post-Secondary Employment Outcomes, USPTO PatentsView, and other federal sources; every figure names its source, and the Sources page lists them in full. Generated November 2026.

NOTES

How the Numbers Are Counted

Ranks

Ranks are among the 50 states and the District of Columbia (1 = highest value, whether or not a high value is good). Where fewer than 51 report, the count is given ("23rd of 33").

Sectors

Sectors are as IPEDS classifies institutions each year. IPEDS moves a whole institution to "public, 4-year or above" once it awards any bachelor's degree, so community colleges that began offering applied bachelor's degrees carry all of their students into the public 4-year sector. Sector series (enrollment shares, public 4-year tuition, graduation rates by sector) reflect these moves.

Research doctorates

Two counts appear. IPEDS counts degrees institutions report as "doctor's degree, research/scholarship", which includes some practice-oriented degrees such as many Ed.D.s; the NSF Survey of Earned Doctorates counts research doctorate recipients and is smaller. Each figure names which it uses. "STEM master's per STEM research doctorate" divides IPEDS STEM master's degrees by IPEDS STEM research doctorates.

Engineering

"Engineering" alone is CIP 14. Where engineering technology (CIP 15) is added, the label says "engineering & eng. technology".

Graduation rates

IPEDS graduation rates follow first-time, full-time students and count only those who finish at the institution where they started, so they leave out part-time starters and students who transfer and finish elsewhere.

International students in SEVIS

SEVIS counts active F-1 and M-1 records, which include graduates on Optional Practical Training (up to 36 months for STEM graduates, 12 for others), so STEM shares run high. STEM follows the DHS STEM Designated Degree Program List, which is broader than the eight CIP families above, and DHS draws its STEM pages on a different basis from its all-student pages, so a country's STEM count can exceed its all-level count.

Visas and green cards

DOL labor condition applications (H-1B positions) are counted by worksite and include renewals and job changes; USCIS approvals are counted by the employer's address and split into new and continuing. PERM certifications are the employer's step toward a green card.

Patents

Patents are counted by the owner's (assignee's) location, not where inventors live; a company headquartered in another state takes its patents there.

Years

Each measure uses its latest year, so years differ across a page; every figure, table and statement gives its year, and lines that stop early are labeled with their last year.

New Mexico – By the Numbers

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION							
Grade 8 mathematics, average score	271	**256**[2024]	−14.7 ▼	272	−9.0 ▼	#51	[5]
Grade 8 mathematics: at or above Proficient	21%	**14%**[2024]	−6.6 pp ▼	27%	−5.3 pp ▼	#51	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics, average score	231	**224**[2024]	−7.3 ▼	237	−2.5 ▼	#51	[5]
Grade 4 mathematics: at or above Proficient	27%	**23%**[2024]	−3.6 pp ▼	39%	0.0 pp	#51	[5]
Grade 8 reading, average score	253	**245**[2024]	−8.2 ▼	257	−7.3 ▼	#51	[5]
Grade 8 reading: at or above Proficient	20%	**19%**[2024]	−1.6 pp ▼	29%	−4.0 pp ▼	#51	[5]
Grade 4 reading, average score	207	**201**[2024]	−6.6 ▼	214	−7.1 ▼	#51	[5]
Grade 8 science, average score, 2009 framework	–	**143**[2015]	–	153	–	#43	[5]
Current spending per public-school pupil	$12.7K	**$14K**[2021]	+10% ▲	$16.8K	+12% ▲	#37	[3]
Public high school 4-year graduation rate, ACGR	69%	**75%**[2019]	+6.0 pp ▲	86%	+3.0 pp ▲	#50	[3]
Public high school graduates	19.7K	**19.2K**[2024]	−2.1% ▼	3.49M	+8.8% ▲	#38	[3]
Average public-school teacher salary	$61K	**$59.6K**[2022]	−2.3% ▼	$72.9K	−3.0% ▼	#38	[3]
Pupils per teacher, public schools	15.5	**14.6**[2022]	−0.9 ▼	15.4	−0.6 ▼	#22	[3]
Public elementary and secondary enrollment	336K	**307K**[2024]	−8.5% ▼	49.4M	−2.1% ▼	#38	[3]
Public-school students eligible for free or reduced-price lunch	63%	**75%**[2023]	+12.6 pp ▲	53%	+1.5 pp ▲	#3	[3]
English learners as a share of public-school students	15%	**19%**[2022]	+4.2 pp ▲	11%	+1.0 pp ▲	#3	[3]
Charter-school share of public-school enrollment	6.7%	**9.9%**[2023]	+3.2 pp ▲	7.6%	+2.2 pp ▲	#11	[3]
High schools offering calculus	42%[2016]	**31%**[2024]	−10.5 pp ▼	51%	−5.8 pp ▼	#46	[14]
High schools offering physics	53%[2016]	**60%**[2024]	+7.0 pp ▲	64%	−2.4 pp ▼	#31	[14]
High schools offering chemistry	74%[2016]	**80%**[2024]	+5.6 pp ▲	81%	+0.7 pp ▲	#33	[14]
High schools offering Algebra II	92%[2016]	**90%**[2024]	−2.1 pp ▼	87%	+1.3 pp ▲	#23	[14]
High schools offering computer science	31%[2021]	**44%**[2024]	+12.9 pp ▲	55%	+2.0 pp ▲	#39	[14]
High schools offering any AP course	43%[2016]	**41%**[2024]	−1.9 pp ▼	56%	0.0 pp	#41	[14]
High schools offering AP computer science	16%[2021]	**15%**[2024]	−0.9 pp ▼	25%	+2.6 pp ▲	#37	[14]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). "pp" is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

NEW MEXICO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
K-12 PREPARATION (CONTINUED)							
High schools offering dual enrollment	82%[2016]	**80%[2024]**	−1.9 pp ▼	71%	+11.1 pp ▲	#20	[14]
AP course enrollments per 100 high-school students	17.7[2016]	**15.0[2024]**	−2.7 ▼	18.4	+1.0 ▲	#25	[14]
Calculus enrollments per 100 high-school students	3.9[2016]	**2.5[2024]**	−1.4 ▼	3.3	−1.0 ▼	#31	[14]
Physics enrollments per 100 high-school students	11.2[2016]	**13.2[2024]**	+2.0 ▲	9.4	−0.4 ▼	#11	[14]
SAT or ACT takers per 100 high-school students	33.1[2016]	**21.7[2024]**	−11.4 ▼	18.1	−2.5 ▼	#19	[14]
Students in gifted and talented programs per 100 students	5.0[2016]	**4.0[2024]**	−1.0 ▼	7.0	+0.4 ▲	#29	[14]
ENROLLMENT AND INSTITUTIONS							
Pell Grant share of undergraduates	40%	**38%[2025]**	−1.7 pp ▼	36%	−0.8 pp ▼	#14	[15]
Fall enrollment	138K	**114K[2024]**	−17% ▼	19.7M	−1.7% ▼	#40	[4]
Share of enrollment at public institutions	95%	**96%[2024]**	+1.3 pp ▲	73%	0.0 pp	#1	[4]
Share of enrollment at for-profit institutions	3.8%	**2.0%[2024]**	−1.8 pp ▼	5.5%	−1.2 pp ▼	#25	[4]
Share of students enrolled part-time	49%	**50%[2024]**	+1.6 pp ▲	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#5	[4]
Share of students who are graduate students	10%	**13%[2024]**	+2.9 pp ▲	17%	+2.0 pp ▲	#40	[4]
Share of students enrolled exclusively online	16%	**31%[2024]**	+14.4 pp ▲	27%	+12.1 pp ▲	#12	[4]
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY							
Research doctorates awarded	345	**272[2025]**	−21% ▼	59K	+7.3% ▲	#39	[7]
Science & engineering research doctorates, excluding health	234	**220[2025]**	−6.0% ▼	44.4K	+14% ▲	#38	[7]
Share of U.S. research doctorates	0.6%	**0.5%[2025]**	−0.2 pp ▼	–	–	#39	[7]
Engineering research doctorates	71	**75[2025]**	+5.6% ▲	10.9K	+9.9% ▲	#31	[7]
Mathematics & computer science research doctorates	23	**18[2025]**	–	5.07K	+33% ▲	#40	[7]
STEM master's degrees per research doctorate	3.5	**4.8[2025]**	+1.3 ▲	6.4	+2.1 ▲	#32	[4]
STEM share of bachelor's	20%	**22%[2025]**	+2.3 pp ▲	24%	+5.3 pp ▲	#30	[4]
Share of bachelor's in computer & information sciences	2.2%	**3.9%[2025]**	+1.7 pp ▲	6.9%	+3.7 pp ▲	#39	[4]
Share of bachelor's in engineering & eng. technology	8.3%	**8.6%[2025]**	+0.3 pp ▲	6.8%	+0.7 pp ▲	#8	[4]
Share of bachelor's in mathematics & statistics	0.7%	**0.6%[2025]**	−0.1 pp ▼	1.2%	0.0 pp	#39	[4]

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NEW MEXICO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
DEGREES AND FIELDS OF STUDY (CONTINUED)							
Share of bachelor's in biological & biomedical sciences	5.4%	**5.9%**[2025]	+0.5 pp ▲	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#34	[4]
Share of bachelor's in physical sciences	1.7%	**1.3%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	1.3%	−0.3 pp ▼	#25	[4]
Share of bachelor's in health professions	8.9%	**15%**[2025]	+6.4 pp ▲	12%	+1.1 pp ▲	#11	[4]
Share of bachelor's in business	16%	**14%**[2025]	−2.6 pp ▼	19%	−0.1 pp ▼	#49	[4]
STEM share of master's	18%	**24%**[2025]	+5.8 pp ▲	23%	+6.7 pp ▲	#18	[4]
Share of master's in computer & information sciences	2.4%	**5.5%**[2025]	+3.1 pp ▲	10%	+6.3 pp ▲	#35	[4]
Share of master's in engineering & eng. technology	8.0%	**11%**[2025]	+3.4 pp ▲	6.7%	−0.2 pp ▼	#2	[4]
Share of master's in mathematics & statistics	1.0%	**0.9%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	1.3%	+0.3 pp ▲	#29	[4]
Share of master's in biological & biomedical sciences	1.5%	**2.0%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	2.5%	+0.6 pp ▲	#34	[4]
Share of master's in physical sciences	2.8%	**2.6%**[2025]	−0.3 pp ▼	0.8%	−0.1 pp ▼	#4	[4]
Share of master's in health professions	14%	**15%**[2025]	+1.0 pp ▲	15%	+1.7 pp ▲	#26	[4]
Share of master's in business	17%	**16%**[2025]	−1.0 pp ▼	21%	−3.2 pp ▼	#44	[4]
STEM share of research doctorates	47%	**53%**[2025]	+5.5 pp ▲	39%	−2.2 pp ▼	#8	[4]
Share of research doctorates in computer & information sciences	3.0%	**4.3%**[2025]	+1.3 pp ▲	4.2%	+1.4 pp ▲	#17	[4]
Share of research doctorates in engineering & eng. technology	18%	**25%**[2025]	+6.7 pp ▲	14%	−1.0 pp ▼	#1	[4]
Share of research doctorates in mathematics & statistics	2.7%	**3.3%**[2025]	+0.6 pp ▲	2.4%	−0.2 pp ▼	#11	[4]
Share of research doctorates in biological & biomedical sciences	4.6%	**5.9%**[2025]	+1.3 pp ▲	10%	−1.1 pp ▼	#44	[4]
Share of research doctorates in physical sciences	19%	**15%**[2025]	−4.3 pp ▼	7.1%	−1.1 pp ▼	#3	[4]
Share of research doctorates in health professions	7.9%	**6.9%**[2025]	−1.0 pp ▼	12%	+3.5 pp ▲	#33	[4]
Share of research doctorates in business	1.4%	**3.0%**[2025]	+1.6 pp ▲	5.6%	+1.3 pp ▲	#31	[4]
Bachelor's degrees per 100 undergraduates	6.7	**7.9**[2025]	+1.2 ▲	12.3	+1.4 ▲	#49	[4]
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS							
First-time students from outside the U.S.	1.8%[2016]	**1.8%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	3.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#38	[4]
STEM master's degrees earned by international students	170	**237**[2025]	+39% ▲	117K	2.18× ▲	#40	[4]
Share of all U.S. international STEM master's degrees	0.3%	**0.2%**[2025]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#40	[4]

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NEW MEXICO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
International share of undergraduate enrollment	1.9%	**1.7%**[2024]	−0.2 pp ▼	3.0%	−0.3 pp ▼	#39	[4]
International share of graduate enrollment	12%	**10%**[2024]	−1.5 pp ▼	17%	+2.8 pp ▲	#34	[4]
International share of all bachelor's	3.7%	**3.3%**[2025]	−0.4 pp ▼	4.1%	+0.1 pp ▲	#23	[4]
International share of STEM bachelor's	8.2%	**7.3%**[2025]	−0.9 pp ▼	6.6%	+0.8 pp ▲	#14	[4]
International share of all master's	9.3%	**11%**[2025]	+2.2 pp ▲	22%	+6.2 pp ▲	#35	[4]
International share of STEM master's	28%	**31%**[2025]	+2.7 pp ▲	52%	+9.1 pp ▲	#40	[4]
International share of computer & information sciences master's	37%	**30%**[2025]	−6.9 pp ▼	65%	+10.1 pp ▲	#41	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology master's	29%	**33%**[2025]	+4.3 pp ▲	50%	+0.9 pp ▲	#35	[4]
International share of mathematics & statistics master's	52%	**41%**[2023]	−10.5 pp ▼	54%	+5.9 pp ▲	#23	[4]
International share of biological & biomedical sciences master's	10%	**12%**[2025]	+2.1 pp ▲	23%	+6.2 pp ▲	#38	[4]
International share of physical sciences master's	31%	**39%**[2025]	+7.3 pp ▲	33%	+3.6 pp ▲	#11	[4]
International share of all research doctorates	27%	**25%**[2025]	−2.6 pp ▼	25%	−1.0 pp ▼	#29	[4]
International share of STEM research doctorates	42%	**34%**[2025]	−7.8 pp ▼	43%	−0.5 pp ▼	#42	[4]
International share of engineering & eng. technology research doctorates	47%	**35%**[2025]	−12.3 pp ▼	55%	−1.0 pp ▼	#39	[4]
International share of physical sciences research doctorates	38%	**18%**[2025]	−19.5 pp ▼	38%	−1.1 pp ▼	#39	[4]
Active F-1/M-1 students, all levels	3.57K	**3.34K**[2026]	−6.5% ▼	1.19M	−0.1% ▼	#42	[20]
Share of U.S. active F-1/M-1 students	0.3%	**0.3%**[2026]	0.0 pp	–	–	#42	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from India	11%	**9.3%**[2026]	−1.9 pp ▼	27%	+11.4 pp ▲	#40	[20]
Share of F-1/M-1 students from China	15%	**3.8%**[2026]	−11.3 pp ▼	18%	−11.7 pp ▼	#44	[20]
Share from the two largest countries of origin	27%	**21%**[2026]	−6.2 pp ▼	45%	−0.3 pp ▼	#46	[20]
Countries of citizenship represented	141	**141**[2026]	+0.0%	219	−2.7% ▼	#39	[20]
Active STEM F-1/M-1 students	1.76K	**1.92K**[2026]	+9.2% ▲	749K	+61% ▲	#42	[20]
Active STEM master's students	592	**779**[2026]	+32% ▲	393K	+90% ▲	#40	[20]
Active STEM doctoral students	624	**738**[2026]	+18% ▲	158K	+61% ▲	#37	[20]

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NEW MEXICO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
INTERNATIONAL STUDENTS (CONTINUED)							
Share of STEM master's students from India	47%	**46%**[2026]	−1.0 pp ▼	58%	−1.8 pp ▼	#36	[20]
U.S. students studying abroad for credit, from the state's institutions	1.11K[2017]	**526**[2024]	−53% ▼	–	–	#48	[1]
Economic contribution of international students, nominal dollars	$91M[2018]	**$84.5M**[2024]	−7.1% ▼	$42.9B	+4.6% ▲	#43	[2]
Jobs supported by international students' spending	835[2018]	**587**[2024]	−30% ▼	356K	−22% ▼	#41	[2]
Share of U.S. student and exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.3%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#39	[16]
Share of U.S. F-1 student admissions, by destination	0.2%	**0.3%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#39	[16]
Share of U.S. J-1 exchange-visitor admissions, by destination	0.3%	**0.4%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#41	[16]
J-1 exchange visitors starting a program in the state	1.32K	**1.39K**[2025]	+5.6% ▲	275K	−14% ▼	#41	[18]
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH							
Graduate students in science & engineering	3.74K	**3.68K**[2016]	−1.7% ▼	620K	+0.4% ▲	#37	[9]
S&E graduate students on temporary visas	1.17K	**1.06K**[2016]	−9.1% ▼	241K	+2.3% ▲	#36	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E graduate students	31%	**29%**[2016]	−2.3 pp ▼	39%	+0.7 pp ▲	#36	[9]
Temporary-visa share of engineering graduate students	38%	**35%**[2016]	−2.8 pp ▼	57%	0.0 pp	#45	[9]
S&E postdoctoral appointees	121	**118**[2016]	−2.5% ▼	45.7K	+1.0% ▲	#39	[9]
Temporary-visa share of S&E postdocs	39%	**48%**[2016]	+9.5 pp ▲	56%	−0.9 pp ▼	#36	[9]
University R&D spending, nominal dollars	$391M	**$582M**[2024]	+49% ▲	$118B	+71% ▲	#37	[6]
Share of U.S. university R&D	0.6%	**0.5%**[2024]	−0.1 pp ▼	–	–	#37	[6]
Federally funded share of university R&D	65%	**63%**[2024]	−1.7 pp ▼	55%	−0.2 pp ▼	#8	[6]
Business-funded share of university R&D	2.2%	**2.0%**[2024]	−0.2 pp ▼	5.4%	−0.4 pp ▼	#44	[6]
State- and locally funded share of university R&D	6.7%	**10%**[2024]	+3.3 pp ▲	5.2%	−0.4 pp ▼	#10	[6]
University R&D in mathematics and computer science, nominal dollars	$7.76M	**$35.2M**[2024]	4.54× ▲	$5.12B	+97% ▲	#27	[6]
University R&D in engineering, nominal dollars	$113M	**$134M**[2024]	+19% ▲	$19.3B	+74% ▲	#32	[6]
University R&D personnel, headcount	6.22K	**7.82K**[2024]	+26% ▲	1.09M	+20% ▲	#35	[6]
Federal R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$3.54B	**$3.68B**[2024]	+3.7% ▲	$193B	+53% ▲	#16	[8]
Federal R&D obligations to universities in the state, nominal dollars	$171M	**$271M**[2024]	+59% ▲	$44.4B	+64% ▲	#34	[8]

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NEW MEXICO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
GRADUATE EDUCATION AND RESEARCH (CONTINUED)							
Defense R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$1.12B	**$1.36B[2024]**	+22% ▲	$97.2B	+60% ▲	#16	[8]
Health (HHS/NIH) R&D obligations to the state, nominal dollars	$95.3M	**$123M[2024]**	+29% ▲	$48.5B	+62% ▲	#38	[8]
NSF, NIH, NASA and DOE Science grants performed in the state, nominal dollars	$155M	**$192M[2025]**	+24% ▲	$45B	+47% ▲	#37	[19]
Federal R&D contracts performed in the state, nominal dollars	$305M	**$371M[2026]**	+65.6 ▲	$59.3B	+22,105.9 ▲	#21	[19]
COLLEGE COSTS AND OUTCOMES							
Median earnings 10 years after entering college	$41.9K[2020]	**$43.9K[2022]**	+4.9% ▲	$47.5K	+11% ▲	#45	[15]
Median earnings 1 year after completing	–	**$44K[2025]**	–	$47.5K	–	#48	[15]
Median debt of completers, nominal dollars	$16.8K	**$15K[2024]**	−11% ▼	$17.6K	−4.6% ▼	#46	[15]
STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$65.2K[2025]**	–	$68.2K	–	#32	[15]
Non-STEM bachelor's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$43.9K[2025]**	–	$51.9K	–	#49	[15]
Bachelor's graduates: median earnings 5 years out	–	**$54.9K[2025]**	–	$68.1K	–	#51	[15]
STEM master's graduates: median earnings 1 year out	–	**$95.1K[2025]**	–	$91.6K	–	#14	[15]
Six-year bachelor's graduation rate, 4-year institutions	40%	**50%[2024]**	+10.5 pp ▲	65%	+5.3 pp ▲	#50	[4]
Completion within 150% of normal time, 2-year institutions	23%	**34%[2024]**	+10.7 pp ▲	41%	+12.1 pp ▲	#38	[4]
In-state tuition & fees, public 4-year	$8.25K	**$7.98K[2023]**	−3.3% ▼	$9.71K	−14% ▼	#43	[4]
State & local appropriations per FTE, public institutions	$13.6K	**$23K[2024]**	+69% ▲	$11.4K	+22% ▲	#3	[4]
Net tuition share of tuition plus state and local appropriations, public institutions	24%	**14%[2024]**	−10.1 pp ▼	43%	−5.9 pp ▼	#51	[4]
Average full-time faculty salary (9/10-month)	$87.3K[2016]	**$84.6K[2024]**	−3.0% ▼	$106K	−4.6% ▼	#39	[4]
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO							
International graduates on OPT working in the state where they studied	31%	**24%[2016]**	−6.8 pp ▼	44%	−1.8 pp ▼	#42	[21]
OPT retention, bachelor's graduates	50%	**42%[2016]**	−7.7 pp ▼	58%	+0.3 pp ▲	#29	[21]
OPT retention, master's graduates	22%	**19%[2016]**	−2.6 pp ▼	39%	−2.5 pp ▼	#41	[21]
OPT retention, STEM graduates	22%	**20%[2016]**	−1.5 pp ▼	37%	−1.9 pp ▼	#41	[21]

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NEW MEXICO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WHERE STUDENTS AND GRADUATES GO (CONTINUED)							
OPT workers employed in the state per OPT graduate of its schools	0.77	**0.54**[2016]	−0.2 ▼	1.00	0.0	#41	[21]
STEM OPT extensions approved, by state of the school	108	**111**[2016]	+2.8% ▲	41.2K	+51% ▲	#40	[21]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year after graduating (PSEO)	69%[2016]	**71%**[2019]	+2.0 pp ▲	72%	−0.1 pp ▼	#14	[11]
Bachelor's graduates working in the state 5 years after graduating (PSEO)	–	**59%**[2016]	–	65%	–	#20	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	57%[2016]	**66%**[2019]	+8.9 pp ▲	67%	+1.5 pp ▲	#14	[11]
Master's graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**68%**[2016]	–	66%	–	#12	[11]
Doctoral graduates working in the state 1 year out (PSEO)	–	**53%**[2016]	–	49%	–	#5	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$40.7K[2016]	**$44.1K**[2019]	+8.3% ▲	$48.1K	+2.3% ▲	#26	[11]
Bachelor's graduates' median earnings 5 years out (PSEO)	–	**$60.5K**[2016]	–	$67.3K	–	#33	[11]
STEM bachelor's graduates' median earnings 1 year out (PSEO)	$52.2K[2016]	**$52K**[2019]	−0.3% ▼	$59.3K	+0.1% ▲	#31	[11]
Net domestic migration of bachelor's-plus adults, per 1,000 residents	−9.6	**−5.9**[2025]	+3.7 ▲	–	–	#44	[12]
Net domestic migration of graduate-degree holders	+130	**−102**[2025]	−232.0 ▼	–	–	#31	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved in from another state	3.9%	**2.9%**[2025]	−1.0 pp ▼	–	–	#24	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who moved out to another state	4.9%	**3.5%**[2025]	−1.4 pp ▼	–	–	#8	[12]
Bachelor's-plus adults who arrived from abroad in the past year	2.43K	**2.83K**[2025]	+16% ▲	–	–	#34	[12]
First-time students who are in-state residents	84%[2016]	**85%**[2024]	+0.6 pp ▲	–	–	#7	[4]
Net student migration (per 100 resident first-time students)	−3[2016]	**−5**[2024]	−2.0 ▼	–	–	#39	[4]
Recent high school graduates who go to college out of state	15%[2016]	**18%**[2022]	+3.5 pp ▲	22%	+2.5 pp ▲	#33	[3]
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS							
Certified H-1B positions, by worksite	1.49K	**1.71K**[2025]	+14% ▲	914K	−24% ▼	#39	[17]
Share of U.S. certified H-1B positions	0.1%	**0.2%**[2025]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#39	[17]
STEM share of certified H-1B positions	60%	**46%**[2025]	−14.6 pp ▼	76%	−7.8 pp ▼	#42	[17]
Median offered H-1B wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$67K	**$90.3K**[2025]	+35% ▲	$119K	+66% ▲	#41	[17]
H-1B positions at H-1B-dependent employers	40%	**9.0%**[2025]	−31.2 pp ▼	22%	−25.7 pp ▼	#40	[17]

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NEW MEXICO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
WORK VISAS AND GREEN CARDS (CONTINUED)							
Green-card labor certifications	152	**213**[2025]	+40% ▲	138K	+75% ▲	#42	[17]
Share of PERM certifications for citizens of India	24%	**36%**[2024]	+12.3 pp ▲	47%	−10.6 pp ▼	#27	[17]
PERM certifications for workers on F-1 student visas	2.0%	**20%**[2024]	+18.0 pp ▲	8.7%	+4.9 pp ▲	#4	[17]
PERM workers with a master's or doctorate	38%	**46%**[2024]	+7.8 pp ▲	47%	−4.9 pp ▼	#19	[17]
STEM share of PERM certifications	21%	**51%**[2025]	+30.2 pp ▲	49%	−25.8 pp ▼	#15	[17]
Median offered PERM wage, nominal dollars, nominal dollars	$59.9K	**$86K**[2025]	+44% ▲	$100K	+9.9% ▲	#22	[17]
New lawful permanent residents (green cards), by state of residence	3.63K	**5.25K**[2024]	+45% ▲	1.36M	+30% ▲	#34	[16]
Share of U.S. new green-card holders	0.3%	**0.4%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#34	[16]
People naturalized as U.S. citizens, by state of residence	2.45K	**2.75K**[2024]	+12% ▲	819K	+12% ▲	#37	[16]
Share of U.S. naturalizations	0.3%	**0.3%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#37	[16]
Share of U.S. temporary-worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.4%**[2024]	+0.3 pp ▲	–	–	#28	[16]
Share of U.S. H-1B worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#40	[16]
Share of U.S. L-1 intracompany-transferee admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.2%**[2024]	+0.1 pp ▲	–	–	#40	[16]
Share of U.S. O-1 extraordinary-ability worker admissions, by destination	0.1%	**0.1%**[2024]	0.0 pp	–	–	#33	[16]
New H-1B approvals (initial), by employer state	243	**311**[2026]	+28% ▲	127K	+14% ▲	#39	[13]
Continuing H-1B approvals, by employer state	157	**376**[2026]	2.39× ▲	268K	+52% ▲	#42	[13]
Share of U.S. new H-1B approvals	0.2%	**0.2%**[2026]	0.0 pp	–	–	#39	[13]
Denial rate, new H-1B petitions	7.6%	**6.0%**[2026]	−1.6 pp ▼	3.4%	−3.0 pp ▼	#3	[13]
New H-1B approvals at colleges and schools (NAICS 61)	49%	**47%**[2026]	−1.6 pp ▼	8.6%	−1.7 pp ▼	#5	[13]
New H-1B approvals in professional, scientific & technical services	31%	**22%**[2026]	−9.1 pp ▼	44%	−12.5 pp ▼	#36	[13]
Five largest employers' share of new H-1B approvals	52%	**40%**[2026]	−12.3 pp ▼	9.1%	−6.7 pp ▼	#18	[13]
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION							
Workers in STEM occupations	48.9K	**72.6K**[2024]	+48% ▲	13.7M	+51% ▲	#35	[12]
STEM workers as a share of all workers	5.5%	**7.5%**[2024]	+1.9 pp ▲	8.1%	+2.1 pp ▲	#25	[12]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

NEW MEXICO – BY THE NUMBERS (CONTINUED)

Measure	2015	Latest	Change since 2015	U.S., latest	U.S. change since 2015	Rank	Source
STEM WORKFORCE AND INNOVATION (CONTINUED)							
Foreign-born share of STEM workers	12%	**13%**[2024]	+1.0 pp ▲	24%	+1.6 pp ▲	#28	[12]
Foreign-born share of STEM workers with a graduate degree	18%	**20%**[2024]	+2.3 pp ▲	41%	+2.2 pp ▲	#36	[12]
Noncitizen share of STEM workers	4.7%	**6.4%**[2024]	+1.8 pp ▲	11%	+0.7 pp ▲	#28	[12]
STEM workers born abroad who arrived in the last 10 years	3.7%	**4.0%**[2024]	+0.4 pp ▲	7.5%	+0.3 pp ▲	#32	[12]
Foreign-born share of residents	9.4%	**9.8%**[2025]	+0.4 pp ▲	15%	+1.3 pp ▲	#22	[12]
Foreign-born share of graduate-degree holders, 25+	8.2%	**9.7%**[2025]	+1.6 pp ▲	21%	+2.8 pp ▲	#36	[12]
STEM jobs, employer survey	50.9K	**61.9K**[2025]	+22% ▲	10.4M	+26% ▲	#35	[10]
STEM jobs concentration vs the U.S., location quotient	1.07	**1.07**[2025]	0.0	1.00	0.0	#12	[10]
Mean annual STEM wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$83.6K	**$120K**[2025]	+43% ▲	$120K	+38% ▲	#11	[10]
Median software developer wage, nominal, nominal dollars	$87.9K[2019]	**$125K**[2025]	+42% ▲	$136K	+26% ▲	#30	[10]
Software developer jobs	3.06K	**3.96K**[2025]	+29% ▲	1.69M	+48% ▲	#40	[10]
Mean annual wage, all occupations, nominal, nominal dollars	$43.2K	**$62.3K**[2025]	+44% ▲	$69.8K	+44% ▲	#33	[10]
Patents granted to assignees in the state	309	**320**[2025]	+3.6% ▲	135K	−0.6% ▼	#35	[22]
Share of U.S.-assignee patents	0.2%	**0.2%**[2025]	0.0 pp	–	–	#35	[22]
Share of the state's patents in digital technologies	17%	**20%**[2025]	+2.6 pp ▲	43%	+1.6 pp ▲	#30	[22]
Share of the state's patents in life sciences	14%	**17%**[2025]	+3.2 pp ▲	17%	+0.4 pp ▲	#24	[22]
Share of the state's patents in semiconductors	14%	**6.3%**[2025]	−7.8 pp ▼	2.9%	−1.7 pp ▼	#3	[22]
Women's share of inventors on the state's patents	12%	**15%**[2025]	+3.2 pp ▲	14%	+3.4 pp ▲	#8	[22]

Superscript years mark the year observed; changes since 2015 start from 2015 or the first later year with data. Rank is among the 50 states and DC (1 = highest). “pp” is percentage points. Dollars are 2024 dollars (CPI-U) unless the measure is labeled nominal. Counts and dollars are rounded to three significant figures (K, M, B). Arrow colors show direction only. Source numbers refer to the list of sources that follows the tables.

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